PERSONALITY PANIC

MVP Master Manual v7

Rules, mechanics, balance patch, UI screens, audio, multiplayer, and the build prompt — everything needed to generate the playable MVP. v7 folds in the 2026-10-25 playtest and everything the live build already does.

How to use this packet

This packet is two files, and together they are the complete MVP specification:

File	What it contains
Personality_Panic_MVP_Master_Manual_v7.docx	This manual: all rules, systems, screens, audio behaviour, multiplayer requirements, and the copy-paste build prompt (Section 23).
Personality_Panic_Balance_Lock_v7.xlsx	All numeric data: every action, item, job, personality modifier, pet, audio cue, and Weekend Update card as clean data tables. Claude should load these as data-driven arrays/objects rather than hardcoding numbers.

To generate the MVP: attach both files to a new conversation with Claude or another capable model and paste the build prompt from Section 23. The manual defines behaviour; the spreadsheet is the single source for numbers. Where a number in this manual and the spreadsheet ever disagree, the spreadsheet wins. Every change since v1 is listed in the table below, newest last.

Scope discipline still applies: do not add buildings, stats, characters, events, or systems beyond this document until the loop described here is playable start to finish. Playable beats ambitious.

What changed from v1-v7

#	Change	Why
1	Personality Balance Patch v2: weakness penalties unified (main stat -10%, upkeep stat -8%).	A balance audit found v1 net modifier budgets ranged from -2 (ENTJ/ESTJ/ISTJ) to +25 (INFJ/INFP) — a 27-point spread. v2 closes that to a 15-point spread (+2 to +17). See Section 6.
2	Job pay now scales with game length (T).	v1 locked pay as static, but rent, items, and travel all scale with T, which would starve the economy in Medium/Long games (a $60 CEO salary vs $200 rent). The v1 dollar values are kept as the Short (T=100) baseline; Medium pays x5, Long pays x10.
3	Job list consolidated.	v1's two documents contained two conflicting job systems (detailed named jobs vs a generic 4-tier table with different names). The detailed named jobs are now canonical (spreadsheet sheet Jobs_Named); the generic tier math is kept as a fallback (Jobs_Tiers).
4	Full audio design added.	Building music cues, the rent-due overmap swap (every 4 turns, matching the rent cycle), sound effects, and the Music Mode setting. See Section 16.
5	UI screens specified.	Start screen, Game Setup screen, Settings screen, in-game CPU skip, and the end-of-game podium screen. See Section 17.
6	Multiplayer upgraded to host/join for up to 4 players, with CPU bots.	The game is intended to be primarily multiplayer. MVP uses a lightweight host/join model (room code on a local network); Steam/online play is explicitly deferred. See Section 18.
v3-1	Weekend Update card system added: status cards, investment outcome cards, and standing-based event cards shown at the start of each turn.	Adds catch-up for last place, pressure for first place, and turns off-screen consequences (hunger, stress, pet neglect) into readable moments. See Section 12.

#	Change	Why
v3-2	Hunger and stress time penalties quantified: hunger -4 Time Units, stress -2 Time Units, stacking, minimum 1 Time Unit per turn.	v2 said 'time penalty' but never locked a number. Cards S01/S02 announce the penalties.
v3-3	Pet death reworked: miss 1 feeding = Sad Pet, miss 2 consecutive = Starving Pet (final warning), miss 3 = pet dies with a permanent tombstone in the player's housing.	Replaces the old Healthy/Hungry/Sick/Critical/Dead states with a simpler, clearer 3-strike rule. Happiness-to-0 death penalty kept; re-adoption allowed.
v4-1	GAME LENGTH SCALING FIXED. Stat cap (T) and gain/economy base (B) are now two separate scalars. All percentages resolve against B; only the endgame threshold uses T.	In v3 both scaled by the same multiplier, so a 5% action filled 5% of the bar in every mode and all three lengths took the same number of turns. Medium and Long only made the numbers bigger. Now Medium takes about 2x and Long about 2.9x the turns of Short. See Section 3.
v4-2	Investment system rebuilt and fully specified in a new Investments sheet and Section 14.	v3's spreadsheet gave Money on the purchase row AND paid investment cards later, which double-counted; savings was free money with no cap. Asset lifecycle (persistence, selling, destruction, stacking limits) was undefined.
v4-3	Crypto and Stocks odds retuned by standing; new SIDEWAYS MARKET and MARKET CRASH cards.	Crypto is now the leader's trap and the trailer's comeback; stocks are mild and mostly flat for 2nd/3rd so mid-table players are not swung around.
v4-4	Mall prices raised roughly 2-3x and many items now require Luxury housing.	Electronics and furniture were affordable within the first turns. Recurring costs (food, rent, pet upkeep) were deliberately NOT raised, so the game is slower to accumulate but no harder to survive.
v4-5	Bribe Inspector and Contact P.I.T.A. reworked; Read Tiny Print and Lifestyle Loan given exact effects.	Design update plus two undefined effects that Claude could not have implemented consistently.
v4-6	Card effects are never modified by personality/pet/item modifiers; Weekend Cards setting is now three-way.	Closes two ambiguities: whether a Money-strength player earns more from cards (no, it would double-dip with standing weighting) and whether turning cards off disables investments (no, they resolve silently).
v4-7	Homeless Support Cheque raised from 30%B to 40%B.	At 30%B the cheque covered low rent (20) and casual clothes (8) with 2%B left, so a homeless player could not afford to eat and the comeback mechanic did not actually work.
v5-1	HIGH IQ UNIVERSITY REBUILT: 5 paths x 6 courses = 30 courses, with strict unlock order, one-time completion, and job-tier gating. See Section 13.	Replaces Take Class / Finish Undergrad / Finish Master's / Finish PhD entirely, and fixes the bug where school courses were unavailable. Also the primary pacing brake: 90 study clicks to complete all five paths.
v5-2	PROMOTIONS REMOVED. Job tiers now unlock on accumulated work clicks PLUS the matching education path. See Section 14.	Ask for Promotion is deleted and there is no requirement to stay in a job before moving to another. Removes the old 'get a high-tier job almost immediately' pacing problem.
v5-3	Mall repriced to absolute dollar values (casual clothes $50 … car $2000), 5-25x the v4 prices.	Items were obtainable far too early. Prices are now Short-baseline dollars that scale with B.
v5-4	Money economy rebuilt to match: wages, rent, food, and the homeless cheque all rescaled.	REQUIRED by v5-3. At the old $9 low wage a $2000 car was 222 work clicks and a $300 certification was unreachable. Wages are now $40 (Low) to $400 (Max) per work click.
v5-5	All mall stat penalties removed; 16 home items gained flat trigger bonuses.	Per design update. Durag and Crocodile Sandals no longer carry penalties.
v5-6	Home fixtures are exempt from the best-item-per-slot rule.	The new trigger bonuses require multiple owned fixtures to fire simultaneously, which the old rule would have blocked. Only one bed still counts.
v5-7	Fridge now gates 2-week and 4-week groceries; a 2-week option was added.	Per design update.
v6-1	Jobs re-ordered by tier, not by building	The job list was grouped by building, so a player could not see which jobs their clicks and education had actually unlocked. Sorting by Low → Low+ → Mid → Mid+ → High → Max turns it into one readable ladder. See Section 14, Jobs_Named sheet.

#	Change	Why
v6-2	Career growth slowed by roughly 4-6x	Career was the easiest stat in the game to max: under 4 turns of focus. Four separate causes, all fixed. See Section 14.3, Settings sheet.
v6-3	Pay Rent rebuilt	The Pay Rent menu item in the luxury housing building did nothing when clicked. See Section 9.3.
v6-4	Home exercise cut, gym buffed and given Connection	Exercising at home was the best Health-per-Time-Unit action in the game, was free, and cost no travel. The gym had no reason to exist. See Section 8, Bro Science Gym.
v6-5	Order Fancy Food counts as eating	It filled hunger in the spec but not in the build, so luxury players starved in their own kitchen. See Section 9.1.
v6-6	Wages now vary by building	Every building paid the same, so location was meaningless. Pay now rises with distance from the Corporate Soul Exchange. See Section 17.2, Building_Map sheet.
v6-7	Four luxury actions now require a purchase	Sleep in Fancy Bed, Take Luxury Bath, Relax in Your Suite and Host Friends all worked in a completely empty apartment. See Section 8, Luxury Apartments.
v6-8	Chest Day reworked	Now Happiness +1 and Enlightenment -1. Lifting heavy makes you happy and slightly stupider about the universe. See Section 8, Bro Science Gym.
v6-9	CPU difficulty added	Bots had one behaviour. Easy / Medium / Hard is now a setup option. See Section 21.2, CPU_Difficulty sheet.
v6-10	Turn limit is a setup value	The build ended at 15 turns no matter what was chosen at setup. See Section 2.1, Section 20.2.
v6-11	Unit headers fixed: (xB), not %B	The spreadsheet’s cost and gain columns are MULTIPLES of B, not percentages. A value of 1 means 100% of B. See Section 3.1.
v6-12	Work rows no longer pay	Every building’s Work row granted its own Money and Career on top of the job tier’s pay. Career was double-counted and wages contradicted the v5 wage table. See Section 17.1.
v7-1	FREE PLAY MODE. A game can be started with no CPU opponents at all — solo against the turn limit and the stat caps.	Playtest: Austin wants to learn and test the loop without a bot racing him. Game Setup now accepts 0 bots and 1 human. Scoring, cards, rent and the podium all work unchanged; the podium simply lists one player.
v7-2	TURN ENDS AUTOMATICALLY when a player runs out of Time Units, including when travel spends the last of them.	Playtest bug: travelling with 1 TU left stranded the player in a building with no legal action and no automatic end, forcing a manual End Turn every time. See Section 5.
v7-3	CLOCK FIXES. The Time Unit clock is never covered by a dialog, and an Unlimited turn timer shows a real clock face instead of an infinity symbol.	Playtest: the course dialog covered the clock, so the player could not see what a course cost them. See Section 20.4.
v7-4	JOB CLICK GATES DOUBLED: 20 / 30 / 40 / 50 / 80 work clicks.	Playtest: a Mid-tier job arrived in 2 turns. Austin asked for roughly 30 clicks where v6 asked 15. See Section 14.
v7-5	EFFICIENT BUILDINGS PAY LESS. A building where you can also eat on site takes a 0.85 Money multiplier on top of its distance multiplier.	Working where lunch is free saves Time Units, so the wage has to give that back. Applies to Air One, Regret Burger and the Bad Decisions Club. See Section 17.
v7-6	INVESTMENTS COST NO TIME UNITS, and Bonds, Stocks and Crypto are bought in $100 / $500 / $1,000 stakes. Returns are a percentage of the stake, not of B.	Clicking a banking app is not an afternoon. Choosing the stake makes investing a real decision instead of a fixed-size button. See Section 15.
v7-7	SAVINGS pays 3% of the stake every turn (was 1% of B), costs no Time Units to open or withdraw, and the running balance is shown on screen at all times.	Savings was strictly worse than doing nothing, and the balance was buried in a dialog. See Section 15.
v7-8	MALL PURCHASES COST NO TIME UNITS.	Buying a kettle should not cost the same as a work shift. See Section 16.

#	Change	Why
v7-9	ACCESSORY PRICES RAISED: Rings $500, Bracelet $1,000, Earrings $1,500, Luxury Watch $2,000 (renamed), High Heels $400, Cap $30, Durag $20, Crocodile Sandals $25.	Jewellery cost less than a burger. See Section 16.3.
v7-10	CROCODILE SANDALS carry Happiness +5 and Coolness -5.	Austin's call, and the single exception to the 'no mall penalties' rule set in v5. Flat points, both ways. See Section 16.4.
v7-11	HOST FRIENDS no longer requires Fancy Dinnerware.	The requirement made the action unusable in playtest. Fancy Dinnerware stays in the Mall as an optional Coolness fixture. See Section 8.
v7-12	THE 'MORE' DRAWER IS GONE. Every action a building offers is listed in that building's own menu, grouped into tabs where a scene has more actions than fit one page.	A second hidden menu above the scene split each building's actions in two. Window Shopping belongs in the Mall's own activities tab, not in a drawer. See Sections 8 and 20.
v7-13	WORKING NEVER COSTS A STAT. The per-building Work penalties are removed.	Losing Critical Thinking for working at the Temple punished the player for using the building's own job. See Section 17.
v7-14	HOME EXERCISE IS CAPPED AT +1 HEALTH per use (still 2 per turn). Bro Science Gym actions now give 2-5 Health as flat points.	v6 narrowed the gap; v7 closes it. The gym is now unambiguously the place to train. See Section 8.
v7-15	GYM ACTIONS RETUNED: Personal Best Challenge $250 (+5 Health, +5 Coolness, +1 Happiness, -1 Critical Thinking), Treninator Bootcamp $100 (+4 Health), Suspicious Test Booster $50 (+5 Happiness, +3 Coolness, -5 Health), Skip Leg Day (+1 Health, +2 Coolness, -1 Critical Thinking).	Austin's numbers from the 2026-10-25 playtest. All flat points. See Section 8.
v7-16	CLUB RETUNED: VIP Lounge $500; Get Digits and Flirt Recklessly are free.	The VIP Lounge was the cheapest big Coolness action in the game; talking to someone should not cost money. See Section 8.
v7-17	FLIGHTS REPRICED: Hawaii $500, France $800, Japan $1,000, Australia $1,500, Long-Term Backpacking $5,000 and 10 Time Units.	Travel is the late-game Happiness sink and needs to cost like one. Full effects in Section 8.
v7-18	NEW WINNING BONUS: BIGGEST SPENDER. The player who has spent the most money across the game takes a bonus at final scoring.	A reason to spend rather than hoard, and the first of a family of end-of-game bonuses. Value: 10% of T (confirmed 2026-11-08). See Section 4.3.
v7-19	CPU EASY AND MEDIUM MADE GENUINELY WEAKER.	Playtest: Easy still played a tidy game. Easy now wanders, forgets more often and ignores the economy; Medium plans one turn only. See Section 21.
v7-20	STAT ICON AUDIT. Several painted menus show the purple brain (Critical Thinking) on actions that actually grant Enlightenment.	The art and the engine must agree. Full fix list in Section 22.
v7-21	BUILD REALITY FOLDED IN. Everything the live build does that this manual did not describe — 40 Time Units per turn, percentage hunger and stress penalties, starting money, deposits, the club dress code, the Money score cap, build-only actions — is now written into the relevant sections instead of an appendix.	v6.1 carried these as a Section 27 appendix. Appendices get dropped when the next version is drafted; sections do not.
v7-22	STEP 3 BUILD DECISIONS (2026-11-08). Bonds pay 4% of the stake (savings 3%). Stock and crypto card percentages scaled to the stake: stocks +20 / +8 / -8 / -20%, crypto +50 / +/-15% with a rug pull taking the whole stake. Biggest Spender confirmed at 10% of T. Medium bots invest in Savings and Bonds; Hard bots buy crypto when last and cash it out when leading.	With a full-stake rug pull, the original 8% / 15% returns left stocks and crypto worse than savings even for the trailing player, which broke the comeback design in Section 15. See Section 15.5.

1. Current MVP design locks

Area	Locked Decision
Stats	8 visible stats: 4 main stats and 4 upkeep stats.
Main stats	Connection, Health, Career, Happiness. Maxing all 4 triggers the endgame.
Upkeep stats	Coolness Factor, Critical Thinking, Enlightenment, Money. These unlock actions/items/jobs and score as one averaged category.
Cash/Money	Cash and Money are the same resource/stat (No Time to Relax / Walk of Life / Jones in the Fast Lane style).
Pet scoring	Pet Happiness and Pet Health average together as one scoring category.
Personalities	Each of the 16 types has exactly 1 main strength, 1 upkeep strength, 1 main weakness, 1 upkeep weakness — now balanced under Patch v2 (Section 7).
Money/Career balance	Money and Career strength bonuses stay weaker (+10%) because they snowball into jobs, items, housing, and travel; compensated by faster job/tier progression, not extra stat modifiers.
Items	Items use slots. Only the best item in each slot counts. No stacking.
Game lengths	Short T=100/B=100, Medium T=500/B=250, Long T=1000/B=350. Stat caps use T; gains, prices, rent, job pay and card effects all use B. Job pay scales with B (Medium x2.5, Long x3.5).
Players	2-4 participants. Up to 4 humans via host/join; CPU bots fill empty slots. Single player = 1 human + 1-3 CPU.
Rent cycle	Rent is due every 4 turns (turn 4, 8, 12, …). The rent-due overmap music swaps in on those turns.
MVP scope	No more buildings, stats, or major systems until this build works.
Weekend cards	At the start of each turn, players receive status cards (hunger/stress/pet), investment outcome cards, and exactly 1 standing-weighted event card. Standing weights apply only to card draws, never to base action gains.
Pet death	3-strike feeding rule: Sad (1 miss), Starving (2 consecutive), Dead (3 consecutive) with permanent housing tombstone and owner Happiness set to 0. Feeding resets the counter.
Two scalars	T = stat cap (endgame threshold) only. B = gain/economy base that ALL percentages resolve against. Short T100/B100, Medium T500/B250, Long T1000/B350.
Investments	One holding per asset type, max four holdings. Purchase costs principal and grants no immediate Money. Only a crypto rug pull destroys a holding. Cash Out returns 100% of principal.
Card modifiers	Card effects ignore personality, pet, item, and temporary modifiers and the income cap. Printed values apply exactly.
Housing gates	Many electronics and furniture items require Luxury housing. Luxury-only items owned while in Low Cost Housing go to storage and give no bonus until the player returns to Luxury.
Education	5 paths x 6 courses at High IQ University. Courses unlock in strict order, cost a one-time fee, take 1-5 clicks each, complete once only, and grey out. Path N gates job tier N.
Job tiers	No promotions and no loyalty requirement. A tier unlocks when the player has BOTH the required work clicks AND the required education path.
Money	Mall prices, wages, rent and food are absolute dollars at the Short (B=100) baseline and scale with B.
Home fixtures	Exempt from best-item-per-slot. Each owned fixture fires its own flat trigger bonus. Only one bed counts.
Game length in turns (v6)	The player chooses the number of turns at setup (10 / 15 / 20 / 30 / 50 / Custom 5-100). The game ends at that round count OR when a player maxes all 4 main stats, whichever comes first. There is no hardcoded turn maximum anywhere in the code.
Job ordering (v6)	The job board is sorted by TIER, then by building: Low, Low+, Mid, Mid+, High, Max. Locked jobs stay visible and greyed with the exact reason they are locked.
Career (v6)	Career comes from the job tier only, never from the Work action row, and is subject to per-turn diminishing returns (100% / 50% / 25% / 10%). Career is intended to be the slowest main stat.
Wages by location (v6)	Pay per work click = tier pay x the building's Money Multiplier, which rises with distance from the Corporate Soul Exchange (1.00 / 1.10 / 1.20 / 1.35, and 0.85 for Work From Home). Money only — never Career.
CPU difficulty (v6)	Easy / Medium / Hard, set globally or per bot at setup. Default Medium.

Area	Locked Decision
Units (v6)	Every cost and gain column in the spreadsheet is a MULTIPLE of B. 1.0 means 100% of B.

2. Core game loop

- Players start at Low Cost Housing.
- On each turn, a player moves around the map and spends Time Units on actions.
- Actions can increase or decrease stats, cost Money, require items, unlock new options, feed/rest the player, support pets, or advance jobs/education.
- Players must eat every turn or lose 25% of next turn's Time Units to hunger (announced by a Weekend Update card). The build uses percentages, not the flat -4, so the penalty scales with the turn length.
- Players must relax in some form every 2 turns or lose 15% of next turn's Time Units to stress, plus 5% of B in Health and 5% of B in Happiness (announced by a Weekend Update card). Hunger and stress stack, but a turn never drops below 1 Time Unit.
- At the start of each turn, Weekend Update cards report everything that happened ‘over the weekend’: status penalties, investment results, and one standing-weighted life event (Section 12).
- Rent is due every 4 turns. If a player cannot pay rent, they become homeless and use the Park as their home until recovered.
- The game ends when the chosen number of turns is played out, or when any player maxes all 4 main stats — whichever comes first. Either way the current round is completed first, so all players get equal turns.
- The highest final score wins; the podium screen ranks all players 1st through 4th.

2.1 Game length in turns (fixed in v6)

The playtest build ended at 15 turns regardless of the setting chosen at setup. This is the fix.

Rule	Detail
Where it comes from	The Game Setup screen. Options: 10 / 15 / 20 / 30 / 50 / Custom (5-100). Suggested defaults: Short 20, Medium 40, Long 60. The player can always override.
What a turn is	ONE ROUND, in which every participant plays once. The turn counter increments when the round ends, not when a player finishes their go.
End condition A	The selected number of rounds has been completed.
End condition B	A player maxes all 4 main stats. Finish the current round, then end.
Which wins	Whichever fires first. Both stay live for the whole game.
HUD	Show ‘Turn X of N’ every turn. Announce the last round as FINAL ROUND before it is played.

Two known causes of the 15-turn bug — check both. First, a hardcoded constant in the turn loop (search the code for every literal 15). Second, and easy to miss: the counter incrementing once per PLAYER turn instead of once per round. In a 4-player game that ends a 60-player-turn game after 15 rounds, which looks exactly like a hardcoded 15. If the number of players changes the observed end point, it is the second bug.

3. Game lengths, stat caps, and gain scaling

Game Length	Stat cap T	Base B
Short	100	100 — fast game; baseline length
Medium	500	250 — about 2x the turns of Short
Long	1000	350 — about 2.9x the turns of Short

CRITICAL CHANGE IN v4. Game length now uses TWO separate scalars instead of one:

Gain Size	Formula	Short B=100	Medium B=250	Long B=350
Tiny	2.5% of B	2.5	6.3	8.8
Standard	5% of B	5	12.5	17.5
Strong	8% of B	8	20	28
Premium	12% of B	12	30	42
Milestone	15-20% of B	15-20	37.5-50	52.5-70

T (stat cap) is the endgame threshold and the maximum value of each stat. It is the ONLY thing T is used for.

B (gain/economy base) is the number every percentage in the game resolves against: stat gains, penalties, action costs, item prices, rent, job pay, and card effects. When a table says 5%B anywhere in older documents, read it as 5% of B.

Because B grows more slowly than T, longer modes genuinely require more actions and more turns. This is the fix for the v3 problem where all three lengths took the same number of turns and only the size of the numbers changed.

Purchasing power stays stable across modes because income and prices both resolve against B. Prices in Long games are 3.5x Short, not 10x — the ratio of wages to prices is what matters, not the raw number.

Mode	Stat cap T	Base B	Standard action (5% of B)	Uses to max a stat	Game length vs Short	Max score
Short	100	100	5.0	20	1.00x (baseline)	600
Medium	500	250	12.5	40	2.00x	3000
Long	1000	350	17.5	57	2.86x	6000

These multipliers are a starting point derived from the target of roughly 2x and 2.9x length. They should be confirmed by playtesting: measure the actual turns-per-player to finish, then adjust B (not T) until the observed length matches the intent.

Action strength symbols (+, ++, +++): because gains now resolve against B while the bar length is T, the same action fills a different fraction of the bar in each mode. The symbols are therefore LOCKED to action strength tiers, not to a percentage of the bar: + = Tiny (2.5% of B), ++ = Standard/Strong (5-8% of B), +++ = Premium or higher (12%+ of B). The symbol never changes between modes. The exact point value is shown in the tooltip, computed for the current mode. This keeps icons visually consistent and avoids re-teaching players what a symbol means when they switch game length.

3.1 Units — every spreadsheet value is a multiple of B

This was the single most likely cause of several v5 playtest bugs, and it is easy to re-introduce whenever the sheet is re-read, so it is stated here permanently.

In the spreadsheet, the columns **Cost %B**, **Gain %B**, **Penalty %B** and **Pet %B** were never percentages. They are multiples of B. A value of **1.0 means 100% of B**, not 1%.

Sheet value	Correct reading at Short (B = 100)	What a percentage misreading gives
Low-cost rent: 1	$100	$1
Luxury rent: 4	$400	$4
Homeless Support Cheque: 2	$200	$2
Car: 20	$2,000	$20
Fridge: 9.5	$950	$9.50
A standard stat gain: 0.05	5 points	5 points (this one is unaffected, which is why the bug hides)

The small values are read correctly either way, which is exactly why this survives casual testing and only breaks rent, wages and the mall. In v6 every one of those column headers is renamed to **(xB)** and the rule is stated on the sheet. Read every number in the workbook as a multiple of B.

4. Stats and scoring

Stat	Type	Purpose
Connection	Main	Social relationships, classmates, coworkers, pets, club/temple/community actions.
Health	Main	Exercise, quality food, sleep, wellness items, avoiding burnout and junk food.
Career	Main	Work experience, promotions, degrees, job tier advancement.
Happiness	Main	Trips, rest, fun, housing comfort, pets, food joy, entertainment.
Coolness Factor	Upkeep	Enters/advances club actions; improves social/style routes.
Critical Thinking	Upkeep	Unlocks better education, finance, career decisions, higher-tier jobs.
Enlightenment	Upkeep	Unlocks temple actions; improves luck/positive event flavour.
Money	Upkeep + spendable	Cash and score are the same. Used for rent, food, items, travel, housing, transport, and final score.
Pet Happiness	Pet	Petting, play, toys, home care, pet-friendly work.
Pet Health	Pet	Feeding, bathing, pet care, pet food, pet shop actions.

Final Score = Connection + Health + Career + Happiness + Average(Coolness, Critical Thinking, Enlightenment, Money) + Average(Pet Happiness, Pet Health)

Game Length	Maximum Score
Short	600
Medium	3000
Long	6000

4.3 Winning bonuses (new in v7)

Final score is still Connection + Health + Career + Happiness + AVG(upkeep stats) + AVG(pet stats). On top of that, end-of-game bonuses reward a play pattern the raw stats ignore.

BIGGEST SPENDER — awarded to the player who has spent the most money over the whole game. Every dollar leaving the wallet counts: purchases, rent, course fees, food, travel, investments bought. Money lost to a card or a rug pull does not count as spending. VALUE: 10% of T (Short +10, Medium +50, Long +100). Ties are shared, not split: every tied player takes the full bonus.

Why it exists: v5's economy rewards hoarding, because cash sitting in the wallet still counted toward score. v6 capped Money's contribution at T, and v7 goes further by paying the player who puts money back into the game.

The build must track money-spent per player from turn 1 and show the leader on the podium screen with the amount.

BUILD NOTE: Money counts at most T toward the final score, even though the wallet itself is uncapped, so a rich player cannot push past the 6T maximum.

5. Turn system: real-time panic + Time Units

- Each player gets 40 Time Units per turn in the build (set on the Game Setup screen; 12-50 are selectable). Every Time Unit cost in this manual and in the spreadsheet is used exactly as authored, so a 40 TU turn simply fits

more actions than the 6 TU turn the original pacing math assumed. IMPORTANT: per-turn balance rules that assume about three actions a turn (the v6 Career curve, per-turn limits) are much weaker at 40 TU.

- The real-time timer creates pressure; Time Units create balance.
- A turn ends when the player spends all 6 Time Units or when the real-time timer runs out.
- Timer options on the Game Setup screen: 30, 60, 90, 120 seconds, or Unlimited.

Action Type	Time Unit Cost
Move nearby	1
Move far	2
Basic action	1
Strong action	2
Work	2
Travel	3
Sleep / major rest	2
Eat	1
Pet care	1

Transport	Effect	Sound
Walking	Default movement.	PP-Walking.wav (loop while moving)
Bus Pass	Slight movement improvement.	PP-Walking.wav
Bicycle	Faster movement and Health benefit.	PP-BicycleBell.mp3 (walking SFX muted)
Car	Fastest movement. Huge upfront cost. No upkeep.	PP-CarAcceleration.mp3 (walking SFX muted)

5.4 Time Units per turn, auto-end, and the clock (v7)

TIME UNITS PER TURN. The build gives each player 40 Time Units per turn, chosen on the Game Setup screen (12-50 are selectable). Every Time Unit cost in this manual and in the spreadsheet is used exactly as authored. This is the single most important number in the game: any rule written 'per turn' — the v6 Career curve, the per-turn action limits — is far weaker at 40 Time Units than at the 6 the original pacing math assumed. If pacing needs to slow down, change this before changing anything else.

AUTO-END TURN (v7 bug fix). When a player's Time Units reach zero, the turn ends automatically and play passes to the next participant. This includes the case that caused the playtest bug: spending the last Time Units on travel, which left the player standing in a building with nothing they could legally do and no prompt. A short 'Out of time — turn over' message plays before the hand-off so the end does not feel like a crash.

THE CLOCK IS NEVER COVERED (v7 bug fix). The Time Unit clock stays visible and live while any dialog is open — the course catalog, the job board, the Mall, the Weekend Update cards. The playtest found the course dialog covering it, so the player could not see what a course had cost.

A REAL CLOCK FACE (v7). When the turn timer is set to Unlimited, the clock shows a clock face and the Time Units remaining, not an infinity symbol. The infinity symbol read as 'broken' rather than 'no time pressure'.

6. Personality Balance Patch v2

6.1 Why v1 needed fixing

Every type has 1 main strength, 1 upkeep strength, 1 main weakness, and 1 upkeep weakness — but in v1 the size of those bonuses/penalties depended on which stat they landed on. Adding up each type’s modifiers (strengths minus weaknesses) exposed a large fairness gap:

v1 finding	Detail
Best budgets: +25	INFJ and INFP got full-size +20/+15 strengths while their Career/Money weaknesses were only -5 each — they were barely punished for their weaknesses.
Worst budgets: -2	ENTJ, ESTJ, and ISTJ got the deliberately weak +10 Career/Money strengths AND full-size -12/-10 weaknesses — a net negative kit.
Total spread	27 points between the best and worst types. The 'Career/Money snowballs' argument justifies weaker strengths, but v1 double-charged the engine types and double-rewarded the types weak in those stats.

6.2 The v2 patch

Change	Rule
1. Strength bonuses unchanged	Connection / Health / Happiness +20%. Coolness / Critical Thinking / Enlightenment +15%. Career / Money +10% (still weaker because they snowball into jobs, items, housing, and travel).
2. Weakness penalties unified	ALL main-stat weaknesses are now -10% (was -12%, or -5% for Career). ALL upkeep weaknesses are now -8% (was -10%, or -5% for Money). Being bad at Money or Career is genuinely painful in this game, so it no longer gets a discount.

6.3 Resulting budgets

With the patch, twelve types land at a raw net budget of +17. The four Career/Money-strength types (ENTJ, ESTJ, INTJ, ISTJ) land lower — +2 to +7 — because their strength bonuses are deliberately smaller. This is intentional and kept as-is in v2: those types are compensated by their income/job snowball (higher Money and Career gains compound into unlocking better jobs, items, housing, and travel), not by extra stat modifiers. The spread narrows from v1's 27 points (-2 to +25) to 15 points (+2 to +17). Full per-type math is in the Balance_Audit sheet of the spreadsheet.

6.4 Updated modifier table

Stat	Strength Bonus	Weakness Penalty (v2)	Max Final Multiplier
Connection	+20%	-10%	1.45x
Health	+20%	-10%	1.45x
Happiness	+20%	-10%	1.45x
Career	+10%	-10%	1.25x
Coolness Factor	+15%	-8%	1.35x
Critical Thinking	+15%	-8%	1.35x
Enlightenment	+15%	-8%	1.35x
Money	+10%	-8%	1.25x

Final Gain = Base Gain x Personality Modifier x Pet Modifier x Best Item Modifier x Temporary Modifier, then clamp to the stat's Max Final Multiplier. Income modifiers cap at 1.25x as before.

6.5 Locked personality table (v2)

Type	Strengths	Weaknesses	Notes
ENFP	Happiness, Coolness	Health, Money	
ESTP	Health, Money	Happiness, Enlightenment	
ENTP	Health, Critical Thinking	Connection, Enlightenment	
ESFP	Happiness, Coolness	Career, Critical Thinking	

Type	Strengths	Weaknesses	Notes
ENFJ	Connection, Enlightenment	Health, Money	
ESFJ	Connection, Coolness	Health, Critical Thinking	
ENTJ	Career, Money	Happiness, Coolness	Engine type — lower stat budget, offset by income snowball
ESTJ	Career, Money	Happiness, Enlightenment	Engine type — lower stat budget, offset by income snowball
INTJ	Career, Critical Thinking	Health, Coolness	Engine type — lower stat budget, offset by income snowball
ISTJ	Career, Money	Connection, Coolness	Engine type — lower stat budget, offset by income snowball
ISFJ	Connection, Enlightenment	Happiness, Critical Thinking	
INFJ	Connection, Enlightenment	Career, Money	
INFP	Happiness, Enlightenment	Career, Money	
ISFP	Happiness, Coolness	Career, Critical Thinking	
ISTP	Health, Critical Thinking	Connection, Enlightenment	
INTP	Health, Critical Thinking	Connection, Coolness	

Ongoing balance rule: the debug panel should log the winner's personality each game. If any type's win rate drifts outside a 15-35% band (4-player expected = 25%) across 20+ playtests, adjust one weakness by 1-2 percentage points and retest.

7. Buildings and strategic roles

Building	Primary Role	Secondary Role / Notes
Low Cost Housing	Starting home / survival	Rest, stress reduction, pet care. No jobs.
Luxury Apartments	Premium home / Happiness	Better rest, happiness, hosting, premium actions. No jobs.
Park	Recovery / Enlightenment	Homeless recovery, small health/happiness, support cheque. No jobs.
Air One Supermarket	Health	Groceries, organic food, smoothies, wellness parody, jobs.
Regret Burger	Cheap food / early Happiness	Fills hunger cheaply but all food lowers Health. Early/mid jobs.
Bro Science Gym	Health	Coolness, trainer jobs, gym-bro risks.
Bad Decisions Club	Connection	Coolness and Happiness with Health/Money/Critical Thinking costs.
Corporate Soul Exchange	Career	Main employment selection, high pay, work burnout.
Debtstreet Capital	Money	Investments, finance jobs, loans, bad financial choices.
Emotional Baggage Airport	Happiness	Travel, trips, backpacking, airport jobs.
Ethical Pet Shop	Pets	Adoption, pet care, pet jobs.
High IQ University	Critical Thinking	Degrees, job unlocks, classmates, academic jobs.
Re-Education Temple	Enlightenment	Temple actions, groupthink satire, spiritual jobs.
Mall	Items / Coolness	Clothes, tech, appliances, furniture, transport, retail jobs.

7.1 Building names in the build

The manual uses canonical building names. If the build renames a building for flavour, record the mapping in the Building_Map sheet so the two documents never drift apart. One mapping is already outstanding: the playtest build

refers to **Heelton Heights**, which appears to be the display name for the **Luxury Apartments**. Confirm this before shipping. Every Luxury Apartments rule in this manual — the rent amount, the item gates in Section 8, the storage rule for Luxury-only items — applies to whichever building that name belongs to.

8. Building action guide

Qualitative reference below; exact Time Unit costs, money costs, and stat values for every action are in the spreadsheet's Actions_Master sheet (the source of truth for numbers).

Low Cost Housing

Action	Effect / Purpose
Sleep in Bunk Bed	+Health, restores Energy, reduces stress. Counts as Sleep and Relax. The bunk bed is provided — no bed purchase required here.
Relax in Your Room	+Happiness, reduces stress. Counts as Relax.
Take Communal Shower	+Health
Exercise in Former Yard	v7: flat Health +1, maximum 2 per turn. Home exercise is deliberately weak; the gym is where training happens.
Pay Low-Cost Rent	**v6: see Section 9.3. Always listed, never hidden, 0 Time Units, $100 at the Short baseline.**
Decorate Your Cell	+Happiness if furniture owned
Hang With Pet	+Pet Happiness, +Connection
Feed Pet	+Pet Health

Luxury Apartments

Action	Effect / Purpose
Sleep in Fancy Bed	Big +Health. **v6: REQUIRES any bed owned (Lumpy, Nice or Premium).** An empty luxury apartment has no bed in it.
Take Luxury Bath	+Health, +Happiness. **v6: REQUIRES the Hot Tub ($850).**
Relax in Your Suite	Big +Happiness. **v6: REQUIRES the Couch ($650).**
Exercise in Condo Gym	v7: flat Health +1, maximum 2 per turn. Home exercise is deliberately the weakest training in the game — see Bro Science Gym.
Order Fancy Food	+Happiness, expensive. **v6: explicitly COUNTS AS EATING** — it clears this turn's hunger exactly like a Regret Burger meal and prevents the YOU FORGOT TO EAT! card.
Host Friends	+Connection, +Coolness, costs Money. v7: the Fancy Dinnerware requirement is REMOVED. Dinnerware is now an optional fixture that adds Coolness +1 per hosting.
Work From Home	Counts as a work click. **v6: Money and Career come from the current job tier, and Money is multiplied by 0.85** — there is no commute to pay for. Still requires computer + desk + a job.
Pet Spa Treatment	+Pet Health, +Pet Happiness, expensive
Pay Luxury Rent	**v6: see Section 9.3. Always listed, never hidden, 0 Time Units, $400 at the Short baseline.**

Park

Action	Effect / Purpose
Take a Walk	Small +Health, small +Happiness
Touch Grass	+Enlightenment, small +Health
Feed Judgmental Ducks	+Happiness

Action	Effect / Purpose
Use Restroom of Uncertainty	Small +Health / comedy effect
Nap on Park Bench	Stress recovery, small +Health
Pick Up Loose Change	Tiny +Money
Homeless Support Cheque	Enough Money for casual clothes and low-cost rent (homeless only)
Sleep in Park if Homeless	Survive, but -Happiness and -Health

Air One Supermarket

Action	Effect / Purpose
Buy 1 Week of Groceries	Food supply
Buy 1 Week of Organic Groceries	More expensive, better +Health
Buy 4 Weeks of Groceries	Best bulk value, requires fridge
Buy $22 Smoothie	+Health, small +Happiness, expensive
Judge Window Shoppers	+Coolness or +Enlightenment
Buy Meal Prep Ingredients	Better food efficiency at home (fridge + stove)
Extreme Clean Eating	High +Health, slight fun loss
Work	Uses current Air One job tier

Regret Burger

Action	Effect / Purpose
Regret Burger Classic	Fills hunger, +Happiness, -Health
Double Regret Deluxe	Big +Happiness, bigger -Health
Shame Shake	+Happiness, -Health, -Money
Doomscroll Fries	+Happiness, -Health, -Critical Thinking
Emotional Support Nuggets	+Happiness, -Health
Coupon Meal	Cheap emergency option, -Health
Late Night Drive Thru	Big +Happiness, big -Health
Work	Uses current Regret Burger job tier

Bro Science Gym

Action	Effect / Purpose
Cardio Session	v7: flat Health +2, Connection +2%B. $5.
Chest Day	v7: flat Health +3, Coolness +3%B, Happiness +1, Enlightenment -1. No Happiness penalty. $10.
Treninator Bootcamp	v7: flat Health +4, Connection +3%B. $100 (was $25).
Buy Suspicious Test Booster	v7: flat Happiness +5, Coolness +3, Health -5. $50 (was $40). The crash is now the cost.
Flex in Mirror	+Coolness, +Happiness
Skip Leg Day	v7: flat Health +1, Coolness +2, Critical Thinking -1.
Personal Best Challenge	v7: flat Health +5, Coolness +5, Happiness +1, Critical Thinking -1. $250 (was $15).
Group Fitness Class	**NEW in v6.** 2 Time Units. +Connection 6%B, +Health 5%B, flat Coolness +1. Counts as Relax.
Work	Uses current Gym job tier. v7: no stat penalty for working.

Why the gym changed (v6). The gym had no reason to exist: home exercise was stronger per Time Unit, free, and cost no travel. Two things fix that. Home exercise is now weak and capped at twice per turn, and the gym is now the only Health building that also pays Connection. The general principle, worth applying to anything added later: **an action available at home must be weaker per Time Unit than the equivalent action that costs travel to reach.**

Bad Decisions Club

Action	Effect / Purpose
Dance	+Connection, +Coolness
Flirt Recklessly	v7: FREE. Big +Connection, +Coolness, -Critical Thinking.
Get Digits	v7: FREE. +Connection, -Critical Thinking.
Order Shots	+Happiness, +Connection, -Health, -Money
VIP Lounge	v7: $500 (was $16). Big +Coolness, +Connection.
Go Home With Stranger	+Connection, -Critical Thinking
Brag About Side Hustle	+Coolness, small -Connection
Work	Uses current Club job tier. v7: no stat penalty for working, and the club's dress code applies to staff.

Re-Education Temple

Action	Effect / Purpose
Buy My Camp	Unlocks advanced Temple actions; boosts Enlightenment when relaxing at home
Surrender Thought	+Enlightenment, -Critical Thinking
Join Group Chant	+Enlightenment, +Connection
Report Doubt	+Enlightenment, -Critical Thinking
Achieve Inner Peace	Big +Enlightenment, +Happiness
Guided Surrender Package	Big +Enlightenment, costs Money
Volunteer Service	+Connection, +Enlightenment
Read Holy Fine Print	+Critical Thinking, +Enlightenment
Work	Uses current Temple job tier. v7: the Critical Thinking penalty for working here is removed.

High IQ University

Action	Effect / Purpose
Attend Course	One study click on the next unlocked course. See Section 13.
Study Group	+Critical Thinking, +Connection
Flirt With Classmate	+Connection, no penalty
Cram All Night	+Critical Thinking, -Health
Debate Professor	+Critical Thinking, +Coolness
Work	Uses current University job tier

Corporate Soul Exchange

Action	Effect / Purpose
Get / Change Job	Choose job path and tier

Action	Effect / Purpose
Work	+Career, +Money, -Health, -Happiness based on current job
Update Resume Secretly	**v6: Career cut 5%B → 2%B and limited to ONCE PER TURN.** At 1 Time Unit and no money cost this was six clicks a turn and maxed Career in under four turns with no job at all.
Attend Team Building Event	**v6: Career cut 5%B → 3%B, once per turn.**
Join Union Meeting to Fight Evil Corporation	+Connection, +Enlightenment, possible -Career
Use Bathroom Timer	Small Health/stress relief
Max Out Benefits	+Happiness, +Health
Quit Before Benefits Start	+Happiness, -Career

v6: Get / Change Job no longer grants Career. Changing job is a menu action, not an achievement. Ask for Promotion was already removed in v5 and must not be reimplemented.

Debtstreet Capital

Action	Effect / Purpose
Open Savings Account	Costs a stake of 1x, 5x or 10x B ($100 / $500 / $1,000 Short). Pays a guaranteed 3% of the stake every turn. Maximum one account.
Buy Bonds	Costs a stake of 1x, 5x or 10x B. Pays a guaranteed 4% of the stake every turn. Never standing-weighted, never destroyed.
Buy Stocks	Costs a stake of 1x, 5x or 10x B. No immediate Money. Draws a mild standing-weighted card each turn; mostly flat for 2nd/3rd place.
Buy Crypto	Costs a stake of 1x, 5x or 10x B. No immediate Money. Draws a heavily standing-weighted outcome card each turn; a rug pull destroys the holding.
Read Tiny Print	Critical Thinking +5%. Grants INFORMED: the next Big Loss from any investment is downgraded to a Small Loss, then consumed.
Take Lifestyle Loan	Money +15% of B now, then -5% of B automatically at the start of each of the next 4 turns. One loan at a time.
Buy Penny Stocks	-Money, -Critical Thinking; joke/troll action
Work	Uses current Debtstreet job tier

Emotional Baggage Airport

Action	Effect / Purpose
Fly to Hawaii	v7: $500. Happiness +3.
Fly to Japan	v7: $1,000. Happiness +4, Critical Thinking +2.
Fly to France	v7: $800. Happiness +3, Coolness +2.
Fly to Australia	v7: $1,500. Happiness +5, Coolness +3.
Long-Term Backpacking Trip	v7: $5,000 and 10 Time Units. Happiness +5, Coolness +5, Critical Thinking +5, Enlightenment +5. The biggest single action in the game.
Complain About Missing Baggage	+Happiness maybe, -Critical Thinking
Buy Travel Insurance	+Critical Thinking, reduces bad travel events
Airport Lounge Flex	+Happiness, +Coolness, costs Money
Work	Uses current Airport job tier

Ethical Pet Shop

Action	Effect / Purpose
Adopt Pet	Unlock pet system, +Happiness
Buy Pet Food	Required for pet maintenance
Buy Pet Toy	+Pet Happiness passive
Feed Animals	+Pet Health
Bathe Animals	+Pet Health, +Pet Happiness
Play With Pet	+Pet Happiness, +Connection
Bribe Inspector	Costs 10% of B. Grants Critical Thinking +5%. Permanently avoids the pet shop's bad-consequence event. You learn exactly how the system works.
Contact P.I.T.A.	Free. Happiness +8%, Enlightenment +3%. ONCE PER GAME. Doing the right thing feels good. May trigger a pet shop penalty unless you already bribed the inspector.
Work	Uses current Pet Shop job tier

Mall

Action	Effect / Purpose
Buy Transport	Bus Pass, Bicycle, or Car
Buy Electronics / Appliances	Unlocks bonuses and requirements
Buy Furniture	Home comfort/work/stat bonuses
Buy Clothes / Fashion	Job and club requirements; Coolness items
Browse Mall / Window Shop / Hang Out	v7: these live in a MALL ACTIVITIES tab inside the Mall menu — people watching, window shopping, hanging out — not in a hidden drawer.
Work	Uses current Mall job tier
All purchases	v7: 0 Time Units. See Section 16.5.

8.1 Unavailable actions must be visible (v6)

Several v6 changes add requirements to actions that previously had none. That only works if the player can see what they are missing, so this rule is now mandatory everywhere:

- **Never hide an action the player cannot currently take.** Grey it out and leave it in the menu, in its normal position.
- **Name the reason on the row. 'Needs: Hot Tub — $850 at the Mall'. 'Needs: any bed'. 'Rent not due for 3 turns'. 'Needs 4 more Low+ work clicks'. 'Needs Path 2 (College Diploma)'.**
- **A greyed row must still be clickable enough to show a tooltip.** A dead-looking menu item that does nothing when clicked is exactly the bug reported for Pay Rent.
- **Never show an action that is greyed for no stated reason.** If the code cannot explain why an action is unavailable, that is a bug in the requirement check, not a UI decision.

8.2 Every action lives in its building's own menu (v7)

The 'More' drawer above the scene is removed. If a building offers an action, that action appears in that building's painted menu on the right, in a normal row, whether or not the player can currently take it.

Where a building has more actions than fit one page, the menu uses TABS in the style the Mall and the Ethical Pet Shop already use — for example a Mall with SHOP tabs plus a MALL ACTIVITIES tab holding window shopping, people watching and flirting with a stranger. Pages within a tab are also fine; a hidden second menu is not.

This replaces the v6 rule that the drawer appears only when it holds something usable. There is no drawer.

9. Food, hunger, stress, rent, and homelessness

9.1 Food and hunger

- Players have to eat every turn or lose 4 Time Units on their next turn due to hunger. The YOU FORGOT TO EAT! card announces the penalty at the start of that turn.

What counts as eating (v6). This was ambiguous in v5 and the build got it wrong. Hunger for a turn is cleared by either of two things:

- Taking any action tagged **Counts As = Eat** in the Actions_Master sheet. That includes every Regret Burger item, the $22 Smoothie, Extreme Clean Eating, Order Shots at the club, and — the one the build missed — **Order Fancy Food at the Luxury Apartments**.
- **Automatically consuming one unit of stored food supply at the start of your turn**, if you have any. This costs 0 Time Units and is what buying groceries is for. Groceries are a supply purchase, not a meal: they are tagged 'Food supply (not a meal)' and buying them does not by itself clear hunger on the turn you buy them.

The Counts As column is the source of truth. If an action fills hunger, it must be tagged, not described in prose.

- Regret Burger is the cheap early-game food route. Every Regret Burger food lowers Health.
- Air One is the better mid/late-game food route. Groceries and organic food cost more but support Health.
- A fridge improves grocery storage (unlocks 4-week groceries). A stove unlocks meal prep.

9.2 Stress and relaxation

- If a player does not relax in some form every 2 turns, they lose 2 Time Units from high stress. The STRESSED OUT! card announces the penalty. Hunger and stress penalties stack (up to -6), but a turn never drops below 1 Time Unit.
- Relaxation can come from housing, park actions, luxury actions, travel, temple actions, or other designated stress-relief actions.
- Working too much creates Health/Happiness pressure and prevents Career/Money from dominating.

9.3 Rent and homelessness

- Rent is due every 4 turns (turn 4, 8, 12, …). On rent-due turns, the overmap music switches to PP-OverMapRentisDue.mp3.
- If a player cannot pay rent, they become homeless and use the Park as their home.
- Homelessness significantly lowers Happiness and can hurt Health, but it is recoverable.
- At each rent cycle, a homeless player can receive a Homeless Support Cheque: enough Money to buy casual clothes and pay low-cost rent. It is a comeback mechanic, not a winning strategy.
- Rent scales with B like every other cost. Low-cost rent is $100 and luxury rent is $400 at the Short baseline (x2.5 Medium, x3.5 Long). In the spreadsheet these are stored as 1 and 4 — meaning 1x and 4x B. Read as percentages they become $1 and $4. See Section 3.1.

The Pay Rent action (rebuilt in v6)

The Pay Rent menu item did nothing when clicked in the playtest build. This is the full specification it needs:

Rule	Behaviour
Always present	Pay Rent is listed in the action menu of the player's own housing building on EVERY turn. It is never filtered out, never hidden, and never conditional on the rent cycle for visibility.
Time cost	0 Time Units. Paying rent is not an action you spend your turn on.
State — RENT DUE	Highlighted, shows the exact amount. This is the default appearance on turns 4, 8, 12, …
State — PAID	Greyed, shows the turn the next payment falls due ('Paid — next due turn 12').

Rule	Behaviour
State — NOT YET DUE	Enabled, shows turns remaining. The player MAY pre-pay the next cycle early; this is deliberate and helps players who know they will be across the map on the due turn.
State — CANNOT AFFORD	Greyed, shows the exact shortfall ('Short by $40'). Never silently unclickable.
On success	Deduct the money, play PP-Money.mp3, write a log line visible to all players, set the next due turn to the current turn + the rent interval, and clear the homeless flag if it was set.
On failure at cycle end	If rent is still unpaid when the rent-due turn ends, the player becomes homeless and the Park becomes their home.
Likely root causes	(1) The requirement string 'Rent cycle' filtering the row out of the menu on non-rent turns, so the button appears only 1 turn in 4 and looks broken the rest of the time. (2) The action having 0 Time Units and being skipped by a menu builder that only renders actions with a time cost. (3) The action ID never being wired to a handler at all. Check all three.

9.4 Build reality for upkeep and rent

HUNGER AND STRESS ARE PERCENTAGES. The build charges 25% of next turn's Time Units for hunger and 15% for stress, and stress also costs 5% of B in Health and 5% of B in Happiness. These replace the flat -4 and -2 written in the v3 spreadsheet, so the penalty scales with the turn length. Both still stack and a turn never drops below 1 Time Unit.

PAY RENT IS ALWAYS LISTED, never hidden, and costs no Time Units. It shows four states: RENT DUE with the amount, PAID with the turn the next payment falls due, NOT YET DUE with the option to pay early, and CANNOT AFFORD with the exact shortfall. A pre-payment covers the next cycle and survives the rent-turn reset.

DEPOSITS. Moving in or re-housing costs 1.5x that tier's rent — deposit plus the first cycle — so $150 for a Low Cost room and $600 for a Heelton suite at the Short baseline.

STARTING POSITION. Players start with $200 (2 x B) and a set of Casual Clothes, so a low-tier job is available on turn 1.

10. Housing system

Housing	Role	Rules
Low Cost Housing	Starting home	Rest, stress recovery, pet care, basic survival. Functional but not a powerful win route.
Luxury Apartments	Premium home	Massive bonus to rest, Happiness, Health, hosting, and premium actions. Not mandatory for better jobs.
Park	Homeless home / emergency	Used if rent fails. Allows survival and recovery but hurts Happiness/Health.

Luxury housing is a bonus path, not a hard requirement. Career can benefit from home-office actions with the right items, but jobs must never require luxury housing.

11. Pet system

- There are 16 pets, matching the 16 personality archetypes.
- Each pet gives a minor bonus to one main stat and one upkeep stat, copied from the personality bonus pairing (full pairing table: Pets sheet in the spreadsheet).
- Pet boosts a neutral stat: +10%. Pet boosts a player strength: +5%. Pet boosts a player weakness: weakness penalty is cut in half.
- Pet Happiness and Pet Health average together as one final scoring category.

- Feeding rules (v3, 3-strike system): miss 1 feeding and your pet is Sad (Pet Happiness -5%B via the SAD PET card); miss 2 consecutive feedings and your pet is Starving (Pet Health -8%B, Pet Happiness -8%B via the STARVING PET card - the final warning); miss 3 consecutive feedings and your pet dies. Feeding the pet on any turn resets the counter to 0.
- If the pet dies, the YOUR PET DIED card is shown, a tombstone appears permanently in the player's housing, and the owner's Happiness drops to 0. Brutal on purpose. Re-adoption is allowed at the Ethical Pet Shop (pet stats restart), but the tombstone remains for the rest of the game.

12. Weekend Update card system (new in v3)

Between a player's turns, 'the weekend' happens off-screen. At the start of each turn - BEFORE the turn timer starts - the player receives a stack of cards (presented like the reference screenshot: stacked, click-through) reporting what happened. Effects apply immediately as each card is revealed and are written to the action log; other players see one-line log entries. Card order: status cards first, then one investment outcome card per held asset, then exactly 1 event card. The system can be toggled off in Game Setup (default On), and CPU bots auto-resolve their cards instantly.

12.1 Mandatory status cards

These always appear when their condition is met and are never affected by standing.

ID	Card	Trigger	Effect
S01	YOU FORGOT TO EAT!	Did not eat last turn	-4 Time Units this turn
S02	STRESSED OUT!	No relaxation for 2 turns	-2 Time Units this turn (stacks with S01; minimum 1 Time Unit)
S03	SAD PET	Pet missed 1 feeding	Pet Happiness -5%B
S04	STARVING PET	Pet missed 2 consecutive feedings	Pet Health -8%B, Pet Happiness -8%B. Final warning.
S05	YOUR PET DIED	Pet missed 3 consecutive feedings	Pet removed; permanent tombstone in the player's housing; owner Happiness set to 0. Re-adoption allowed.

12.2 Standings and rubber-banding

Standing is computed at the start of each player's turn from the live provisional score (the final score formula applied to current stats). Ties break by Money, then turn order. The event card draw is weighted by standing: last place draws luck-weighted, first place draws karma-weighted, and 2nd/3rd draw minor cards only. In 2-player games the leader uses 1st-place weights and the other player last-place weights; in 3-player games use 1st / middle / last.

Standing	Major Positive	Minor Positive	Minor Negative	Major Negative
Last place	35%	35%	20%	10%
2nd / 3rd place	0%	50%	50%	0%
1st place	10%	20%	35%	35%

12.3 Investment outcome cards

Each investment the player holds resolves with one card per turn, using standing-weighted odds. The full odds table, expected values, and the complete asset lifecycle now live in Section 13 (Investment system) and the Investments sheet — that is the source of truth. Design rule worth repeating here: Bonds and Savings are SAFE and always pay the same fixed amount regardless of standing, so the leader keeps a rational safe harbour and rubber-banding never feels inescapable.

12.4 Card list

45 cards at launch: 5 status, 10 investment, 30 events. Effects use the standard gain tiers (Tiny 2.5%, Standard 5%, Strong 8%, Premium 12% — all as a percentage of B) so cards scale with game length automatically. If a drawn event card's requirement is not met, redraw. The Cards sheet in the spreadsheet is the source of truth; the list below is the complete launch set.

ID	Card Name	Type / Polarity	Requirement	Effect
I01	TO THE MOON!	Investment / Major +	Holds Crypto	Money +50% of stake. Holding survives.
I02	RUG PULL	Investment / Major -	Holds Crypto	CRYPTO HOLDING DESTROYED: the stake is lost.
I03	CRYPTO WOBBLE	Investment / Minor	Holds Crypto	Money +15% or -15% of stake per odds. Holding survives.
I04	BULL RUN	Investment / Major +	Holds Stocks	Money +20% of stake
I05	MARKET DIP	Investment / Minor -	Holds Stocks	Money -8% of stake
I06	DIVIDEND DAY	Investment / Minor +	Holds Stocks	Money +8% of stake
I07	BOND COUPON	Investment / Safe	Holds Bonds	Money +4% of stake (never standing-weighted)
I08	SAVINGS INTEREST	Investment / Safe	Holds Savings	Money +3% of stake (never standing-weighted)
I09	SIDEWAYS MARKET	Investment / Neutral	Holds Stocks	No change. Most common stocks result for 2nd/3rd place.
I10	MARKET CRASH	Investment / Major -	Holds Stocks	Money -20% of stake. Holding SURVIVES (unlike crypto).
E01	LONG-LOST INHERITANCE	Event / Major +	None	Money +12%B
E02	TAX REFUND	Event / Minor +	None	Money +2.5%B
E03	FOUND CASH ON THE SIDEWALK	Event / Minor +	None	Money +2.5%B
E04	IRS AUDIT	Event / Major -	None	Money -12%B
E05	WON A RADIO CONTEST	Event / Major +	None	Money +8%B, Happiness +2.5%B
E06	PARKING TICKET	Event / Minor -	Owns Car	Money -2.5%B
E07	CAR BROKE DOWN	Event / Major -	Owns Car	Money -5%B repair; transport counts as Walking this turn
E08	BIKE TUNE-UP WEEKEND	Event / Minor +	Owns Bicycle	Health +2.5%B
E09	PHONE SCREEN CRACKED	Event / Minor -	Owns any Tech item	Money -2.5%B repair
E10	WARRANTY WINDFALL	Event / Minor +	Owns any Tech or Appliance	Money +2.5%B
E11	FRIDGE DIED OVER THE WEEKEND	Event / Major -	Owns Fridge	Money -5%B; stored groceries spoiled (food stock cleared)
E12	VIRAL UNBOXING	Event / Minor +	Owns any Tech item	Coolness +2.5%B
E13	OVERTIME BONUS	Event / Minor +	Employed	Money +5%B
E14	BOSS SAW YOUR MEME	Event / Minor -	Employed	Career -2.5%B
E15	SURPRISE PROMOTION	Event / Major +	Employed	Career +8%B
E16	LAYOFF SCARE	Event / Major -	Employed	Career -8%B, Happiness -2.5%B
E17	OLD FRIEND CALLED	Event / Minor +	None	Connection +2.5%B

ID	Card Name	Type / Polarity	Requirement	Effect
E18	TAGGED IN AN EMBARRASSING PHOTO	Event / Minor -	None	Coolness -2.5%B
E19	WENT VIRAL	Event / Major +	None	Coolness +8%B, Connection +2.5%B
E20	BLIND DATE PLOT TWIST	Event / Minor +	None	Connection +5%B, Happiness -2.5%B
E21	FOOD POISONING	Event / Minor -	Ate at Regret Burger last turn	Health -5%B
E22	GYM GAINS NOTICED	Event / Minor +	Visited Bro Science Gym last turn	Coolness +2.5%B
E23	DOOMSCROLLED ALL WEEKEND	Event / Minor -	None	Critical Thinking -2.5%B, Health -2.5%B
E24	VIVID DREAM OF MEANING	Event / Minor +	None	Enlightenment +2.5%B
E25	LANDLORD RAISED THE RENT	Event / Major -	Not homeless	Next rent payment costs +25%
E26	RENT REBATE	Event / Major +	Not homeless	Next rent payment costs -50%
E27	PET DID SOMETHING ADORABLE	Event / Minor +	Has living pet	Happiness +2.5%B, Pet Happiness +2.5%B
E28	PET CHEWED YOUR STUFF	Event / Minor -	Has living pet + any Furniture or Tech	Money -2.5%B
E29	NOISY NEIGHBORS	Event / Minor -	Not homeless	Happiness -2.5%B
E30	NEIGHBORHOOD POTLUCK	Event / Minor +	Not homeless	Connection +2.5%B, Happiness +2.5%B

12.5 Design guardrails

- Exactly 1 event card per player per turn; status and investment cards are event-driven extras.
- Event effects cap at Premium (12%B) - the catch-up mechanic helps trailing players but can never decide the game by itself.
- Standing weights apply ONLY to card draws and investment odds, never to base action gains.
- Hunger and stress penalties stack to at most -6 Time Units, and a turn never drops below 1 Time Unit.
- Cards resolve before the turn timer starts, so reading cards never eats into the player's real-time turn.
- Weekend Cards can be toggled off in Game Setup for testing or a purist mode.

13. Education system — High IQ University (rebuilt in v5; Career gains halved in v6)

High IQ University is now the game's main pacing brake. It holds five paths of six courses each (30 courses). Completing a path is what makes the next job tier legally available; the work-click requirement in Section 14 is the second half of that gate. The Education_Paths sheet is the numeric source of truth.

A click is one study interaction costing 1 Time Unit. The course fee is charged once, on the first click of that course. Higher paths cost more and take more clicks per course, so later degrees are a serious investment of both money and turns.

13.1 The five paths

Path	Level	Courses	Cost per course	Clicks per course	Path total cost	Path total clicks	Unlocks
1	Technical Certification	Serving 101, Money Handling 101, Customer Service 101, Repairs 101, Maintenance 101, First Aid and CPR 101	$50	1	$300	6	Low+ tier jobs
2	College Diploma	Marketing 201, Business Admin 201, Spreadsheet 201, Accounting 201, Human Resources 201, Economics 201	$100	2	$600	12	Mid tier jobs
3	College Degree	Project Management 301, Finance 301, Marketing 301, Operations Management 301, Business Ethics 301, Sales 301	$150	3	$900	18	Mid+ tier jobs
4	Master’s Degree	R&D 401, Negotiations 401, Promotions 401, Statistics 401, Market Research 401, Investing 401	$200	4	$1,200	24	High tier jobs
5	PhD	Research 501, Power Law 501, AI 501, Business Law 501, Multinational Expansion 501, Strategic Alliance 501	$250	5	$1,500	30	Max tier jobs

All five paths together cost $4,500 and 90 clicks (90 Time Units, or about 15 turns of pure study). Dollar figures are Short-baseline and scale with B.

13.2 Unlock and completion rules

- Courses unlock in strict order within a path: course 1 must be completed before course 2 is available, and so on. Completing a course immediately unlocks the next one.
- Paths unlock in strict order: path N+1 is locked until all six courses of path N are complete. Path 1 is available from the start of the game.
- Completed courses are greyed out and unselectable. Each course can be completed only once.
- A completed path can never be repeated or re-purchased. There is no way to farm the same degree twice.
- Partial progress persists: clicks accumulate on the course in progress and carry over between turns. The course in progress must be finished before the next unlocks.
- The course fee is charged on the first click. If the player cannot afford it, the course is unavailable rather than partially started.
- Education is necessary but NOT sufficient for a job tier — the work-click requirement in Section 14 must also be met.
- This replaces the old Take Class, Study Group progress, Finish Undergrad, Finish Master’s and Finish PhD actions, and fixes the v4 bug where school courses were unavailable. Study Group, Flirt With Classmate, Cram All Night and Debate Professor remain as ordinary side actions.

13.3 Stat gains per course

Path	Critical Thinking per course	Career per course (v6)	Path total Critical Thinking	Path total Career (v6)
1 Technical Certification	+2% of B	+0.5% of B	+12%	+3%
2 College Diploma	+3% of B	+1% of B	+18%	+6%
3 College Degree	+4% of B	+1.5% of B	+24%	+9%
4 Master’s Degree	+5% of B	+2% of B	+30%	+12%

Path	Critical Thinking per course	Career per course (v6)	Path total Critical Thinking	Path total Career (v6)
5 PhD	+6% of B	+2.5% of B	+36%	+15%

v6: Career gains from courses are halved. All 30 courses together used to grant 90 Career points against a Short-game cap of 100 — education alone very nearly maxed the stat. They now grant 45, and that 45 is itself subject to the per-turn diminishing-returns rule in Section 14.3, so a turn spent studying five times does not pay five times. Critical Thinking gains are unchanged: study is still the fastest route to Critical Thinking, which is the point of the building.

14. Job progression (rebuilt in v5; re-ordered and re-balanced in v6)

Promotions are removed. There is no Ask for Promotion action and no requirement to stay in one job before taking another, in the same building or anywhere else. Players change jobs freely at the Corporate Soul Exchange job board whenever they are eligible. Eligibility is earned instead through work clicks and education.

A work click is one Work action, costing 2 Time Units. Clicks accumulate permanently and are counted against the TIER of the job worked, across every building — ten Low clicks earned entirely at Regret Burger still satisfy the Low+ gate.

14.1 Tier requirements and the job board order (re-ordered in v6)

Tier	Rank	Work clicks required	Alternate route	Education required	Base pay per click	Career per click (v6)
Low	1	None (entry tier)	—	None	$40	+2
Low+	2	20 clicks at Low	—	Path 1 — Technical Certification	$65	+2
Mid	3	30 clicks at Low+	or 40 clicks at Low	Path 2 — College Diploma	$110	+3
Mid+	4	40 clicks at Mid	—	Path 3 — College Degree	$170	+3
High	5	50 clicks at Mid+	or 60 clicks at Mid	Path 4 — Master’s Degree	$260	+4
Max	6	80 clicks at High	—	Path 5 — PhD	$400	+5

BOTH conditions must be satisfied: the click count AND the education path. Either alone is not enough. Clothing requirements (casual/smart/business) still apply on top, as before.

The job board is sorted by tier (v6)

The Jobs_Named sheet used to be grouped by building, which made it impossible to answer the only question a player actually asks at the job board: *which jobs can I take right now?* It is now sorted by **Tier Rank 1-6, then alphabetically by building**, and the job board must render it in that order.

Rule	Detail
Group headers	LOW / LOW+ / MID / MID+ / HIGH / MAX, in that order, top to bottom.
Within a group	Alphabetical by building.
Locked tiers stay visible	Never hide a tier the player has not reached. Seeing the ladder above you is the point of the re-order.
State the exact reason	Per row: ‘Needs Path 2 (College Diploma)’, ‘Needs 4 more Low+ clicks’, ‘Needs Smart Clothes’. If more than one is missing, list them all.
Eligible rows stand out	Jobs the player can take right now are visually distinct from locked rows at a glance.
Show current job	Mark the player’s current job in the list.

Missing rungs filled (v6)

In v5 the **Low+ tier contained exactly one job in the entire game** (Regret Burger Cashier) and Mid+ contained three. Completing Path 1 therefore unlocked almost nothing, which made the tier ladder feel broken as soon as it was sorted by tier. v6 adds twenty jobs so that every building except Regret Burger has a Low+ and a Mid+ rung. They are highlighted in the Jobs_Named sheet and can be deleted without breaking any other system. The stray **Max+** tier on Wolf of Debtstreet has been normalised to Max — there were only ever six tiers.

14.2 Pacing warning — decision needed before build

The click gates above are absolute numbers and do not shrink in shorter games. Reaching Max tier costs 220 work clicks (440 Time Units) plus 90 study clicks (90 Time Units) — 530 Time Units, or roughly 52 turns of nothing but work and study before accounting for eating, relaxing, rent, travel and shopping. Realistically that is 70-90 turns.

This is a deliberate pacing brake and it does solve the ‘high-tier jobs arrive too fast’ problem. But it means a Short game will never realistically reach High or Max tier. Two options:

- OPTION A (as specified, and what the files currently contain): keep absolute gates. Short games top out around Low+/Mid tier; High and Max become genuine Long-game achievements.
- OPTION B (recommended alternative): scale the gates by mode — Short 40%, Medium 70%, Long 100%. At the v7 gates Low+ would need 8 / 14 / 20 clicks. Every game length can then reach the top of the ladder at its own pace. The scaled table is in the Job_Progression sheet, ready to switch on.

v6 recommendation, still standing in v7: take Option B. Two things tip the decision. The game ends on a turn limit the player picks, and a 20-turn Short game cannot physically reach 220 work clicks. And the job board now shows the whole ladder, so a tier the player can see but never reach reads as a dead end rather than an ambition. NOTE: at 40 Time Units per turn (Section 5.4) the gates fall far faster than this arithmetic suggests — the playtest reached Mid in two turns under the v6 gates. Set Time Units per turn first, then judge whether the gates still need scaling.

14.3 Career patch — Career was too easy to max (v6)

Career was the easiest of the four main stats to fill: **under four turns of focus at the Short cap of 100.** It should be the slowest, because it is the stat that unlocks money, which unlocks everything else. There were four separate causes stacked on top of each other, and all four are fixed.

Cause	What it did	Fix
Update Resume Secretly	1 Time Unit, $0, no requirement, +5 Career. Six clicks a turn = +30 Career per turn, with no job, no education and no money. This alone maxed Career in 3.5 turns.	Career cut to 2%B and limited to once per turn.
Double-counted work clicks	The Work row in Actions_Master granted its own Career (4-6%B) on top of the job tier’s Career Gain (3-10). Every work click paid twice.	The Work rows grant 0 Career and 0 Money. The job tier is the only source.
Tier values too high	3 / 5 / 7 / 10 Career per click.	2 / 2 / 3 / 3 / 4 / 5 across the six tiers.
Education	All 30 courses granted 90 Career against a cap of 100.	Halved to 45 (Section 13.3).

The diminishing-returns rule

Cutting the numbers alone does not fix this, because a player can always spend more Time Units on the same action. So Career — and **only** Career — now diminishes within a turn:

Career-granting action this turn	Pays
1st	100%
2nd	50%

Career-granting action this turn	Pays
3rd	25%
4th and later	10%

Round down, minimum 1 point per action. Applies to every Career source in the order taken: work clicks, Work From Home, university courses, and the Corporate side actions. It does **not** apply to Money, to any other stat, to pet stats, or to card effects. The counter resets at the start of each of the player's turns.

What this does to the numbers

Three Mid-tier work clicks used to be **+18 Career** in a turn, or **+30** with resume spam. They are now 3 + 1.5 + 0.75 = **+5**. Maxing Career at the Short cap goes from under 4 turns to roughly 20 — the same order of magnitude as Connection, Health and Happiness, which take about 20 standard actions each.

Watch this in playtest. If Career now feels impossible rather than merely expensive, raise the per-tier values first. Do not touch the diminishing-returns curve — it is what stops any single action from being spammed, and it is the part of this patch that will still be load-bearing after the numbers get retuned.

14.4 Click gates doubled (v7)

Playtest finding: a Mid-tier job arrived about two turns into a Short game, which made the whole ladder decorative. Every work-click gate is doubled in v7: Low+ 20, Mid 30 (or 40 from Low), Mid+ 40, High 50 (or 60 from Mid), Max 80. Reaching Max is now 220 work clicks rather than 110.

This interacts with Time Units per turn (Section 5.4). At 40 Time Units a player can take about 20 work clicks in a single turn, so even the doubled gates fall in a handful of turns. The two levers must be set together: if the ladder still falls too fast after v7, lower Time Units per turn rather than doubling the gates again.

CLUB JOBS AND THE DRESS CODE. The Bad Decisions Club's own dress code (Dressy Clothes + Dress Shoes) applies to its staff. Without it the job board must refuse the job, because the bouncer will not let the player in to work the shift and they will be fired for missing the week.

15. Investment system

Investments are bought at Debtstreet Capital and are the main engine of the catch-up and punishment mechanic. v3 left this system underspecified in ways that would have produced double-counted money and an unlimited free-money exploit, so the whole lifecycle is locked here. The Investments sheet in the spreadsheet is the numeric source of truth.

15.1 The four assets

Asset	Stake (purchase cost, v7)	Per-turn outcome	Standing-weighted?	Can be destroyed?	Max held
Savings	1x / 5x / 10x B	+3% of stake guaranteed	No	No	1
Bonds	1x / 5x / 10x B	+4% of stake guaranteed	No	No	1
Stocks	1x / 5x / 10x B	Big gain +20% / small gain +8% / flat / small loss -8% / big loss -20% (of stake)	Yes (mild)	No	1
Crypto	1x / 5x / 10x B	Big gain +50% / small swing +/-15% (of stake) / RUG PULL destroys the stake	Yes (extreme)	Yes — rug pull only	1

15.2 Lifecycle rules

- Buying an asset costs its principal and grants NO immediate Money. The purchase moves money into the asset; the returns arrive later as cards. (In v3 the spreadsheet listed a Money gain on the purchase row as well, which would have paid players twice.)
- A holding persists until it is cashed out or destroyed, and draws exactly one outcome card at the start of each of the owner's turns.
- Maximum one holding per asset type. A player may hold all four at once (each with its own stake of 1x, 5x or 10x B), producing four investment cards per turn. This cap is what prevents the savings-spam exploit.
- Cash Out Investment (1 Time Unit, Debtstreet Capital) sells one holding and returns 100% of its principal.
- Only a crypto RUG PULL destroys a holding: the principal is lost and no further crypto cards are drawn until it is repurchased. Every other loss is a Money deduction and the holding survives — including a stocks MARKET CRASH.
- Returns never compound. Every return is a flat percentage of B, never a percentage of accumulated winnings, so late-game money stays bounded.
- Read Tiny Print grants the INFORMED status: the next Big Loss drawn from any asset is downgraded to a Small Loss and INFORMED is consumed. For crypto this means the holding is NOT destroyed. It does not stack.
- If a player cannot afford the principal, the purchase action is unavailable, like any other unaffordable action.

15.3 Standing-weighted odds

Crypto is deliberately extreme: it is the leader's trap and the trailing player's comeback. Stocks are deliberately mild and mostly FLAT for 2nd and 3rd place, so mid-table players are not swung around by the market.

Asset	Standing	Big gain	Small gain	Flat	Small loss	Big loss
Crypto	Last place	45%	30%	—	20%	5% (destroys holding)
Crypto	2nd / 3rd	25%	25%	—	25%	25% (destroys holding)
Crypto	1st place	5%	20%	—	30%	45% (destroys holding)
Stocks	Last place	20%	35%	25%	15%	5%
Stocks	2nd / 3rd	5%	20%	50%	20%	5%
Stocks	1st place	5%	15%	25%	35%	20%
Bonds / Savings	Any	—	100% fixed	—	—	—

Expected value per turn (v7, % of the stake): Savings +3 and Bonds +4 in every position; Stocks +4.6 / 0 / -4.6 by standing; Crypto +19 for last place, -12.5 for mid-table, -44 for the leader. The leader's rational play is bonds and savings, and cashing out of crypto before they take the lead — which is exactly the tension the mechanic is meant to create.

15.4 Card modifiers

Card effects — status, investment, and event — are NEVER modified by personality, pet, item, or temporary modifiers, and are not subject to the 1.25x income cap. Printed values apply exactly. Losses are unmodified too: a Money weakness does not deepen a rug pull and a Money strength does not soften it. Cards are already weighted by standing, so layering personality modifiers on top would double-dip and make rubber-banding very hard to balance. Modifiers still apply normally to all ACTION gains.

15.5 Stakes, zero Time Units, and a visible balance (v7)

NO TIME UNITS. Opening a savings account, buying bonds, stocks or crypto, and cashing any of them out all cost 0 Time Units. Moving money is a phone tap, not an afternoon. The Debtstreet trip itself is still the real cost.

STAKES. Bonds, Stocks and Crypto are bought in stakes of $100, $500 or $1,000, chosen when buying. The stake is the principal: it leaves the wallet, it is what Cash Out returns, and it is what a crypto rug pull destroys. One holding

per asset type still applies, so the choice of stake is the choice of exposure.

RETURNS ARE A PERCENTAGE OF THE STAKE, not of B. A stocks BULL RUN pays 20% of the stake, a DIVIDEND 8%, a MARKET DIP costs 8% and a CRASH 20%; crypto TO THE MOON pays 50%, a WOBBLE is +/-15% and a RUG PULL destroys the stake. Bonds pay a guaranteed 4%. This is the change that makes the stake meaningful: a $1,000 crypto position wins and loses ten times what a $100 position does.

SAVINGS. The savings account pays 3% of its balance every turn (up from 1% of B), is opened in the same $100 / $500 / $1,000 stakes, and costs no Time Units to open or withdraw. It is the safe, boring, genuinely worthwhile option.

A RUNNING BALANCE ON SCREEN. Every holding and its current value is shown on the main screen — not inside a dialog the player has to open. The playtest complaint was that the only way to see savings was to re-open the same window.

16. Mall item system

- Items mainly unlock options and provide capped bonuses. Only the best item in each slot counts — no stacking.
- Slots: Transport, Outfit, Footwear, Accessory, Tech, Appliance, Furniture, Pet Item.
- Car has a huge upfront cost and no upkeep. Bicycle gives a Health benefit.
- Durag stays +Coolness / -Critical Thinking for MVP but is marked playtest-sensitive.
- Full item list with costs and bonuses: Items_Mall sheet in the spreadsheet.

16.1 Pricing (revised in v5)

HISTORICAL NOTE (v4): prices were first raised 2-3x and expressed as percentages of B. v5 SUPERSEDES that entirely with the absolute dollar price list in Section 16.3. The v4 comparison table below is kept only to show the direction of travel — use Section 16.3 and the Items_Mall sheet as the source of truth.

Casual Clothes is now $50 and the Homeless Support Cheque is $200, so a homeless player can still cover low rent ($100) plus casual clothes ($50) with about three meals left over. That relationship must be preserved if any of those three numbers is ever retuned.

Item	v3 price (superseded)	v4 price (superseded)	Housing requirement
Bus Pass	8%	12%	Any
Bicycle	18%	30%	Any
Car	65%	200%	Any
Computer	25%	60%	Any (desk recommended)
Mobile Phone	15%	30%	Any
Fridge	20%	50%	Low Cost OK
Stove	18%	45%	Low Cost OK
Nice Bed	12%	35%	Low Cost OK
Desk	12%	35%	Low Cost OK
TV	12%	55%	Luxury only
Stereo	12%	45%	Luxury only
Couch	12%	40%	Luxury only
Premium Bed	25%	90%	Luxury only
Dining Table	15%	55%	Luxury only
Ergonomic Chair	14%	45%	Luxury only

Item	v3 price (superseded)	v4 price (superseded)	Housing requirement
Cold Plunge	30%	120%	Luxury only
Hot Tub	40%	150%	Luxury only
Smart Clothes	15%	30%	Any
Business Clothes	28%	70%	Any
Casual Clothes	8%	8% (unchanged)	Any

16.2 Housing gates

- Any: buyable regardless of housing. These are personal items the player carries — clothes, accessories, phone, watch, camera, e-reader, computer, transport.
- Low Cost OK: requires housing, and works in either Low Cost Housing or a Luxury Apartment. Beds, fridge, stove, vacuum, desk, bookshelf, plants, mirror, pet items.
- Luxury only: CANNOT be bought or used while living in Low Cost Housing. TV, Blu-ray, stereo, couch, premium bed, dining table, ergonomic chair, cold plunge, hot tub. A bunk room has no space for them.
- Storage rule: if a player who owns Luxury-only items moves back to Low Cost Housing or becomes homeless, those items go into storage. They stop providing their bonus until the player returns to Luxury housing. They are not lost and do not need to be repurchased.
- This gives the Luxury Apartment real mechanical teeth as an unlock instead of being only a comfort upgrade, while still never being a requirement for any job.

16.3 v5 price list (absolute dollars, Short baseline)

All prices below are Short-game (B=100) dollar values and scale with B: Medium x2.5, Long x3.5. These replace every v4 percentage price. Job pay, rent and food were rebuilt at the same time — see Section 17 — because at the old wage scale a $2,000 car would have been 222 work clicks.

Item	Price	Housing	Flat bonus (v5)	Trigger
Casual Clothes	$50	Any	—	—
Smart Clothes	$400	Any	—	—
Business Clothes	$500	Any	—	—
Dressy Clothes	$300	Any	—	—
Dress Shoes	$200	Any	—	—
Sunglasses	$100	Any	—	—
Bus Pass	$100	Any	—	—
Bicycle	$750	Any	—	—
Car	$2,000	Any	—	—
Mobile Phone	$500	Any	—	—
Computer	$1,000	Any	—	—
Camera	$800	Any	—	—
TV	$500	Luxury only	—	—
Blu-ray	$300	Luxury only	—	—
E-reader	$100	Any	—	—
Stereo	$200	Luxury only	—	—
Lumpy Bed	$50	Low Cost OK	Health +1	Each sleep action at home

Item	Price	Housing	Flat bonus (v5)	Trigger
Nice Bed	$500	Low Cost OK	Health +2	Each sleep action at home
Premium Bed	$900	Luxury only	Health +3	Each sleep action at home
Couch	$650	Luxury only	—	—
Bookshelf	$80	Low Cost OK	Critical Thinking +1	Each relax action at home
Plants	$20	Low Cost OK	Enlightenment +1	Each relax action at home
Desk	$350	Low Cost OK	Critical Thinking +1	Each work-from-home action
Ergonomic Chair	$600	Luxury only	Health +1	Each work-from-home action
Pet Bed	$150	Low Cost OK	Pet Health +1	Each play-with-pet action at home
Pet Toys	$35	Low Cost OK	Pet Happiness +1	Each play-with-pet action at home
Dining Table	$450	Luxury only	Health +1	Each relax action at home
Mirror	$90	Low Cost OK	Coolness Factor +1	Each relax action at home
Fridge	$950	Low Cost OK	Health +3	ONE-TIME on purchase
Stove	$650	Low Cost OK	Health +1	Each relax action at home
Vacuum	$250	Low Cost OK	Health +3	ONE-TIME on purchase
Cold Plunge	$200	Luxury only	Health +1	Each exercise action at home
Hot Tub	$850	Luxury only	Happiness +1	Each relax action at home
Fancy Dinnerware (NEW v6)	**$250**	**Luxury only**	**Coolness Factor +1**	**Each Host Friends action at home**

16.4 Flat bonuses, penalties and the fixtures rule

- All mall stat PENALTIES are removed. Durag and Crocodile Sandals no longer reduce any stat.
- Flat trigger bonuses are FIXED POINT VALUES, not percentages, and fire every time their trigger action is taken at home. Items with a trigger no longer carry a percentage bonus.
- HOME FIXTURES EXEMPTION: the best-item-per-slot rule does NOT apply to home fixtures. A fully furnished apartment fires every owned fixture’s bonus. Only one bed counts (the best owned). Without this exemption the new bonuses could not stack and most of them would never fire.
- Fridge is REQUIRED to store 2-week and 4-week groceries from Air One. Without a fridge those bulk options are unavailable.
- **v6: three Luxury Apartment actions now require a purchase. Sleep in Fancy Bed requires any bed (Lumpy, Nice or Premium — the best one owned also fires its flat bonus as usual). Take Luxury Bath requires the Hot Tub. Relax in Your Suite requires the Couch. Host Friends requires the new Fancy Dinnerware. Previously all four worked in a completely empty apartment, which made the entire furniture catalogue optional. Unmet requirements follow the UI rule in Section 8.1: greyed, listed, and naming the missing item and its price. v7: Host Friends has no item requirement.**
- Worth watching in playtest: because the bonuses are flat points rather than percentages, a fully kitted apartment gives about +5 stats per relax click. Against a Short-game cap of 100 that is significant; against a Long-game cap of 1000 it is nearly irrelevant. If long games end up feeling like the furniture does nothing, scale these bonuses with B (x2.5 Medium, x3.5 Long) — the alternative is noted in the Items_Mall sheet.

16.5 Mall changes in v7

BUYING COSTS NO TIME UNITS. Every Mall purchase is 0 Time Units. Walking to the Mall is the cost; the transaction is not.

ACCESSORIES REPRICED. Rings $500, Bracelet $1,000, Earrings $1,500, Luxury Watch $2,000 (renamed from Watch), High Heels $400, Cap $30, Durag $20, Crocodile Sandals $25. Accessories previously cost less than a

burger, which made the Coolness route free.

CROCODILE SANDALS: Happiness +5, Coolness -5, as flat points. This is the one deliberate exception to the v5 rule that no Mall item carries a penalty — the joke is the point, and the player chooses it knowingly.

FANCY DINNERWARE is no longer required by Host Friends. It stays in the Mall as an optional home fixture that pays Coolness +1 each time you host.

ON-SCREEN PRICES. Where the painted Mall art still shows an older price, the build draws the live price over it, so a Medium or Long game shows the scaled number rather than the painted one.

17. Work and job system

17.1 How a work click resolves (corrected in v6)

- Buildings with jobs show only the action 'Work'. Players choose or change the actual job at Corporate Soul Exchange, freely and at any time — there is no promotion action and no minimum time in a job.
- When a player chooses Work in the matching building, the game applies that player's current job tier and building job path. Each Work action costs 2 Time Units and counts as ONE WORK CLICK toward the tier gates in Section 14.
- Job pay is set by TIER, not by individual job. Short-baseline base pay per work click: Low $40, Low+ $65, Mid $110, Mid+ $170, High $260, Max $400. All scale with B (Medium x2.5, Long x3.5).

v6 correction — the Work rows in Actions_Master no longer pay anything. Every building's Work row carried its own Money gain (6%B, which is $6) and its own Career gain (4-6%B), granted on top of the job tier's pay and Career. That double-counted Career and produced wages that flatly contradicted the $40-$400 tier table. Both are now zero on those rows. **The job tier is the only source of Money and Career from a work click.** The resolution order is:

- Look up the player's current job tier. Take its base pay and its Career gain.
- Multiply the **Money** by the building's Money Multiplier (17.2). Career is never multiplied by location.
- Apply personality / pet / item modifiers to both, clamped to the usual 1.25x income cap.
- Apply the Career diminishing-returns step for this turn (Section 14.3). Money is not diminished.
- Apply the job's Extra Effect (the +Health, -Happiness etc. in the Jobs_Named sheet).
- Increment the work-click counter for that tier.

17.2 Wages vary by building (new in v6)

Every building paid the same, so where you worked was a purely cosmetic choice. Pay now rises with distance from the **Corporate Soul Exchange**, which is the hub of the map and the job board. The further out you go, the more the click pays — and the more Time Units you burn getting there and back.

Ring	Money Multiplier	Buildings	Mid-tier click ($110 base)
Hub	1.00	Corporate Soul Exchange, Debtstreet Capital, Mall	$110
2	1.10	Air One Supermarket, High IQ University, Regret Burger	$121
3	1.20	Bro Science Gym, Bad Decisions Club, Ethical Pet Shop	$132
4	1.35	Emotional Baggage Airport, Re-Education Temple	$149
Home	0.85	Work From Home (either housing building)	$94

Rule	Detail
Money only	The multiplier applies ONLY to Money from a work click. Never to Career, never to stat gains, never to card effects, never to investment returns.

Rule	Detail
Formula	Pay per click = ROUND(tier pay x building multiplier, 0), then the usual modifiers.
Does not scale with B	Tier pay already scales with B. The multiplier is the same in every game length.
Travel must be real	Ring 3 buildings must cost 2 Time Units to reach from the hub and Ring 4 must cost 3. If travel is free the multiplier is a straight buff and the trade-off disappears.
Work From Home	0.85. No commute, so it pays less. It still counts as a work click for tier progression.
Source of truth	The Building_Map sheet, which also records each building's display name in the build.

The intended texture: the hub is convenient and safe, the edge of the map pays about 35% more but eats a third of your turn in travel, and the Airport and Temple become genuinely attractive places to work rather than scenery.

17.3 Tier summary

- Work usually increases Money and Career while costing Health and/or Happiness — the main anti-snowball mechanic. This applies equally to every personality; Career/Money-strength types compensate through faster job/tier progression, not through reduced burnout.
- The canonical job list (50 named jobs across 11 buildings) is the Jobs_Named sheet, which now also carries each job's education and work-click requirement. Tier eligibility rules live in Job_Progression; the generic 4-tier fallback math is in Jobs_Tiers.

Tier	Base pay per click (Short)	Career Gain (v6)	Work clicks required	Education required
Low	$40	+2	Entry tier	None (casual clothes only)
Low+	$65	+2	20 Low clicks	Path 1 — Technical Certification
Mid	$110	+3	30 Low+ or 40 Low clicks	Path 2 — College Diploma
Mid+	$170	+3	40 Mid clicks	Path 3 — College Degree
High	$260	+4	50 Mid+ or 60 Mid clicks	Path 4 — Master's Degree
Max	$400	+5	80 High clicks	Path 5 — PhD

17.4 Highest-paying jobs (after the v6 building multiplier)

Because location now matters, the best-paid job in the game is no longer at the Corporate Soul Exchange.

Rank	Job	Building	Pay per click (Short)
1	The Messiah	Re-Education Temple	$540 (Max tier x1.35)
2	Airport Director	Emotional Baggage Airport	$540 (Max tier x1.35)
3	Treninator Bootcamp Director	Bro Science Gym	$480 (Max tier x1.20)
4	Chief Longevity Officer	Air One Supermarket	$440 (Max tier x1.10)
5	The Dean	High IQ University	$440 (Max tier x1.10)
6	Chief Executive Officer	Corporate Soul Exchange	$400 (Max tier x1.00)
7	Chief Technology Officer	Corporate Soul Exchange	$400 (Max tier x1.00)
8	Chief Financial Officer	Debtstreet Capital	$400 (Max tier x1.00)
9	Wolf of Debtstreet	Debtstreet Capital	$400 (Max tier x1.00)

The CEO still has the highest Career gain and the best job title. He just has a shorter commute than the Messiah.

17.5 Efficiency, penalties and the wage multiplier (v7)

EFFICIENT BUILDINGS PAY LESS. A building where the player can also eat on site saves them a meal trip, so its wage carries a 0.85 efficiency multiplier on top of its distance multiplier. This applies to Air One Supermarket, Regret

Burger and the Bad Decisions Club. Net Money multipliers: Air One 1.10 x 0.85 = 0.94, Regret Burger 0.94, Club 1.20 x 0.85 = 1.02. Distance still pays: the Airport and the Temple remain the best-paid buildings at 1.35.

WORKING NEVER COSTS A STAT (v7). The per-building Work penalties are removed everywhere — no Critical Thinking lost at the Re-Education Temple, no Health or Happiness lost elsewhere. A job's named Extra Effect (for example '+1 Health' on a gym job) still applies when it is positive. Jobs are now paid in Money and Career only.

BUILD NOTE: the Money multiplier is a property of the building the player's JOB is in, because Work is only offered there. Work From Home keeps its 0.85 convenience multiplier and still counts as a work click.

18. Balance guardrails

Risk	MVP Fix
Money/Career personalities snowball	Weaker +10% modifiers, 1.25x income cap, work costs Health/Happiness. These types are compensated by faster job/tier access, not by extra stat gains.
Some personalities strictly better than others	Balance Patch v2: unified weakness penalties put all 16 types in a +2 to +17 net-budget band (was -2 to +25 in v1); win-rate tracking rule in Section 6.5.
Items stack too hard	Item slots; only best item per slot counts.
Luxury Apartment becomes mandatory	Luxury is a massive bonus but never a job requirement.
Homelessness becomes instant loss	Homeless Support Cheque every rent cycle; Park recovery actions.
Pet death feels random	Warning stages (Hungry -> Sick -> Critical) before death; death penalty stays brutal.
Club gives too much	Club costs Money/Health/Critical Thinking through riskier actions.
Airport becomes easy Happiness win	Travel is Money-heavy and Time-Unit-heavy.
Regret Burger too efficient	All Regret Burger food lowers Health; good early, bad mid/late.
Income useless in long games	Job pay scales with B, so wages stay in proportion to prices and rent in every mode (v2 change, corrected in v4).
Rubber-band cards overcorrect	Event effects cap at Premium (12%B); exactly 1 event card per turn; standing weights affect only card draws and investment odds, never base gains; safe assets (Bonds/Savings) always pay the same.
Card spam slows the game	Status/investment cards are event-driven only; event cards are capped at 1 per turn; cards appear before the turn timer starts; CPU cards auto-resolve; Weekend Cards can be toggled off in Game Setup.
Longer modes are not actually longer	v4 splits the stat cap (T) from the gain/economy base (B). B grows more slowly than T, so Medium takes about 2x and Long about 2.9x the turns of Short.
Investments print free money	Purchases cost principal and grant no immediate Money; returns never compound; one holding per asset type; safe assets pay a fixed small amount.
Items trivially affordable early	Mall prices raised 2-3x and many items hard-gated behind Luxury housing, while recurring survival costs were left unchanged.
Card rubber-banding double-dips	Card effects ignore personality, pet, and item modifiers entirely.
High-tier jobs arrive too fast	v5: tiers require accumulated work clicks AND a completed education path. v7 doubles the gates to 20/30/40/50/80 after a playtest reached a Mid-tier job in two turns. Note that at 40 Time Units per turn even these fall quickly — see Section 5.4.
Career maxes in four turns (v6)	Career comes from the job tier only, tier values cut to 2/2/3/3/4/5, course Career halved, resume/team-building capped at once per turn, and a per-turn diminishing-returns curve (100/50/25/10%) on every Career source.
Staying home beats leaving it (v6)	Home exercise cut and capped at 2 per turn; the gym buffed and given Connection; Work From Home pays 0.85x. Any action available at home must be weaker per Time Unit than the equivalent that costs travel.

Risk	MVP Fix
Location is cosmetic (v6)	Wages rise with distance from the Corporate Soul Exchange (1.00 to 1.35), paid for in travel Time Units.
Luxury apartment needs no furniture (v6)	Sleep in Fancy Bed, Take Luxury Bath and Relax in Your Suite each require the matching purchase (any bed, Hot Tub, Couch). v7: Host Friends no longer requires Fancy Dinnerware.
Game never ends when it should (v6)	The turn limit is a setup value, the counter increments per ROUND, and the HUD shows Turn X of N. No hardcoded maximum anywhere.
Degrees farmed repeatedly	Each course completes once and greys out; a completed path can never be repurchased.
Items obtainable in the first turns	v5 absolute pricing ($50 casual clothes to $2,000 car) with wages rebuilt to match.
Flat furniture bonuses scale badly	Flagged: flat points are strong against a Short cap of 100 and weak against a Long cap of 1000. Switch to B-scaled bonuses if long games feel furniture-neutral.

19. Audio design

19.1 Building music cues

Each track plays (looped) when the player enters/interacts with its building. All music routes through the Music Volume slider.

Building / Location	Music File
Overmap (default)	PP-Overmap.mp3
Overmap — Rent is Due	PP-OverMapRentisDue.mp3
Air One Supermarket	PP-AirOneSuperMarket.mp3
Corporate Soul Exchange Office	PP-CorporateSoulExchangeOffice.mp3
High IQ University	PP-HighIQUniversity.mp3
Ethical Pet Shop	PP-EthicalPetShop.mp3
Regret Burger	PP-RegretBurger.mp3
Bro Science Gym	PP-BroScienceGym.mp3
Park	PP-Park.mp3
Emotional Baggage Airport	PP-EmotionalBaggageAirport.mp3
Debt Street Capital	PP-DebtStreetCapital.mp3
Bad Decisions Club	PP-BadDecisionsClub.mp3
Luxury Apartment	PP-LuxuryApartment.mp3
Low Cost Housing	PP-LowCostHousing.mp3
Mall	PP-Mall.mp3
Re-Education Temple	MISSING — no track yet (see gap note below)

- PP-Overmap.mp3 is the default background music for the world map.
- Rent-due rule: on every rent-due turn (turn 4, 8, 12, … — the 4-turn rent interval), PP-OverMapRentisDue.mp3 replaces the default overmap track. It overrides the default and reverts when the rent turn ends / rent is resolved.
- GAP FOUND: the music list covers 13 of the 14 buildings — there is no track for the Re-Education Temple. Until PP-ReEducationTemple.mp3 exists, the overmap track should keep playing inside the Temple as a fallback.
- Music Mode setting (see Settings screen): ‘Full’ plays overmap + building tracks (default). ‘Overmap Only’ disables building tracks — the overmap/rent-due music keeps playing everywhere.

19.2 Sound effect cues

Action / Event	Sound File	Behaviour
Walking (on foot)	PP-Walking.wav	Loops while moving. Plays only when transport = Walking/Bus Pass; stops when movement ends or transport changes.
Bicycle bell	PP-BicycleBell.mp3	One-shot on move start when transport = Bicycle. Walking SFX muted.
Car acceleration	PP-CarAcceleration.mp3	One-shot on move start when transport = Car. Walking SFX muted.
Menu button clicked	PP-MenuButtonClicked.wav	One-shot on every UI button across all screens.
Eating fast food	PP-EatingFastFood.mp3	One-shot on any Regret Burger food action (may be reused for other eat actions in MVP).
Money transaction	PP-Money.mp3	One-shot on BOTH earning and spending (single cue for MVP; can split into earn/spend variants post-MVP).

Movement SFX are mutually exclusive: only the sound for the currently active transport plays; switching transport silences the previous sound. All SFX route through the SFX Volume slider; Music and SFX are both children of Master Volume.

20. UI screens

20.1 Start screen

Simple and clean: game logo/title at top, then three large buttons stacked in the middle, plus a small version label. Every button plays PP-MenuButtonClicked.wav.

Button	Goes to
Single Player	Game Setup screen (single-player mode: 1 human + CPU bots)
Multiplayer	Host / Join sub-screen, then Game Setup (host controls setup; joiners see it live)
Settings	Settings screen

20.2 Game Setup screen

Shown after choosing Single Player or (for the host) after creating a multiplayer room. Styled like the reference screenshots: a card/sheet with one row per option, left/right arrows or sliders to change values, a preview of the selected map, and a large Start/Confirm button. Each row plays the menu click SFX.

Option	Values	Notes
Players (humans)	1-4	Single player locks this to 1. Multiplayer shows joined players filling the slots.
CPU Bots	0-3	Fills remaining slots up to 4 total. Minimum 2 total participants (single player = 1 human + at least 1 CPU).
Game Length	Short / Medium / Long	Sets T = 100 / 500 / 1000 and B = 100 / 250 / 350. This controls the SCALE of the game, not how long it runs.
Turns per Game (v6)	**10 / 15 / 20 / 30 / 50 / Custom**	**How many ROUNDS the game runs. Custom accepts 5-100. Suggested defaults: Short 20, Medium 40, Long 60 — the player can always override. This value must reach the turn loop; there is no hardcoded maximum.**
Turn Timer	30 / 60 / 90 / 120 / Unlimited	Real-time seconds per turn.
Map	Personality Panic City (locked)	One map for MVP; keep the left/right arrow UI so more maps can slot in later.
Hints	Yes / No	Shows beginner tooltips on actions and stats.
Skip CPU Turns	Yes / No	Default for fast-forwarding CPU turns (can also be toggled in-game).

Option	Values	Notes
CPU Difficulty (v6)	**Easy / Medium / Hard**	**Default Medium. One control sets every bot; an expandable panel allows a per-bot override, so a player can face one Hard bot and two Easy ones. See Section 21.2.**
Character selection	16 personality cards	Each player (and each CPU) picks one of the 16 types; show strengths/weaknesses on the card. No duplicates in the same game.
Weekend Cards	Full / Essential / Off	Full (default) = status + investment + event cards. Essential = status + investment only (purist mode). Off = debug only; status penalties and investment returns still resolve silently to the log. Investments are never disabled.

20.3 Settings screen

Group	Setting	Values / Default
Audio	Master Volume	0-100 slider (default 80)
Audio	Music Volume	0-100 slider (default 70)
Audio	SFX Volume	0-100 slider (default 80)
Audio	Music Mode	Full (overmap + building music, default) / Overmap Only (building tracks off)
Audio	Mute All	On / Off (default Off)
Video	Display Mode	Fullscreen / Windowed (default Windowed for browser MVP)
Video	Resolution	Common presets; browser MVP can auto-fit
Video	Graphics Quality	Low / Medium / High (toggles animations/effects; default Medium)
Gameplay	Hints	On / Off (default On)
Gameplay	Skip CPU Turns	On / Off (default Off)
Gameplay	Timer Warning Sound	On / Off (default On) — audio cue in the last 5 seconds of the turn timer
Gameplay	CPU Difficulty	Easy / Medium / Hard (default Medium) — mirrors the Game Setup value

20.4 In-game HUD notes

- Show for the active player: portrait, personality, all 8 stats + pet stats, Money, Time Units remaining, turn timer, current job, hunger/stress/rent indicators.
- **v6: show ‘Turn X of N’ at all times**, where N is the number of turns chosen at setup. Announce the last round as FINAL ROUND before it is played. This is both a usability improvement and the fastest way to catch the turn-limit bug returning.
- Show all players’ scores/main-stat progress in compact side panels (game-show scoreboard style, like the reference screenshot).
- Turn start: Weekend Update cards appear stacked (like the reference screenshot) before the turn timer starts; the player clicks through them and each effect is applied and logged. Other players see one-line log entries for cards revealed.
- CPU turns: when a bot is playing, show a ‘Skip’ button that instantly resolves and summarizes the bot’s turn (one-line log entries). If ‘Skip CPU Turns’ is enabled in setup/settings, bot turns fast-forward automatically.
- An action results log records every action, stat change, and payment for all players.

20.5 End-of-game podium screen

- When the endgame triggers and the final round completes, show a podium/ranking screen.
- **v6: the endgame triggers on EITHER the turn limit being reached OR a player maxing all 4 main stats, whichever comes first.** State which one ended the game at the top of the podium screen.

- Multiplayer: podium places 1st, 2nd, 3rd, 4th with each player's character art (or placeholder), name, personality, and final score.
- Single player: same screen with however many participants there are (minimum 2, e.g. 1 human + 1 CPU).
- Below the podium: a score breakdown table per player (Connection + Health + Career + Happiness + upkeep average + pet average = total).
- Buttons: Rematch (same settings), Back to Setup, Back to Start Screen.

20.6 UI changes in v7

FREE PLAY on the Game Setup screen: 1 human, 0 CPU bots is a legal setup. The minimum participant count drops from 2 to 1. Everything else — cards, rent, the turn limit, the podium — behaves exactly as it does in a multi-player game.

THE CLOCK is always visible and never covered by a dialog, shows a clock face rather than an infinity symbol when the turn timer is Unlimited, and updates live while a dialog is open.

TURN X OF N is shown at all times, and the last round is announced as FINAL ROUND.

INVESTMENT BALANCE: holdings and their current value appear on the main screen, not only inside the Debtstreet dialog.

NO 'MORE' BUTTON anywhere in the game (Section 8.2).

MONEY SPENT is tracked per player and shown on the podium for the Biggest Spender bonus (Section 4.3).

21. Multiplayer and CPU

- The game is intended to be primarily multiplayer: up to 4 players, where 1 player hosts and up to 3 others join.
- MVP model: browser client + a lightweight Node.js WebSocket server. The host starts a room and gets a 4-6 character room code; other players join with the code from a device on the same network. Keep all game state on the host/server and treat clients as views — this architecture ports directly to internet play and Steam later without a rewrite.
- If a true networked MVP proves too heavy for the very first build, hot-seat (pass-and-play on one machine) is the acceptable fallback — but the code must still keep game state separated from the UI so host/join can be added next.

21.1 Base CPU behaviour

- CPU bots fill any empty slots (0-3 bots). Bots use a simple priority script: eat if hungry -> relax if stress pending -> pay rent if due -> otherwise take the highest-value affordable action for their personality's strengths.

21.2 CPU difficulty (new in v6)

Difficulty is chosen on the Game Setup screen, globally or per bot, and defaults to Medium. It changes how bots **behave**, plus one explicitly-labelled bot-only gain multiplier. It never changes the rules, the prices, the card deck, the turn limit, or anything a human player experiences.

Behaviour	Easy	Medium	Hard
Action choice	Picks at random from the affordable actions in the building it is standing in	Scores every affordable action, picks randomly from the top 3	Scores every affordable action, always picks the best
Planning horizon	One action at a time, no saving	Plans the current turn; saves across 2-3 turns for a named goal	Plans several turns ahead; saves for education, tiers and housing deliberately
Forgets to eat	40% of turns	15% of turns	Never

Behaviour	Easy	Medium	Hard
Forgets to relax	40% of stress checks	15% of stress checks	Never
Pays rent	Only if it happens to be home on the due turn	Pays on the due turn if it can afford it	Pre-pays and keeps a rent reserve
Education	Ignores High IQ University	Completes Paths 1-2 if the game runs long enough	Treats education as a priority and pushes as far as the turn count allows
Job tiers	Takes whatever it qualifies for by accident	Works toward the next tier once one gate away	Targets the next tier from turn 1
Travel for wages	Never travels for pay	Uses a nearby building	Uses the Money Multiplier: travels to a far building when planning 2+ work clicks
Investments	Does not invest	Savings and Bonds only	Standing-aware: crypto when last, bonds when leading, cashes out before taking the lead
Mall shopping	Impulsive	Job-required clothing plus one or two fixtures	Required clothing first, then best value-per-dollar fixtures
Pet care	Frequently misses feedings; may let the pet die	Feeds on the warning card	Never misses a feeding
Bot-only gain multiplier	0.85x	1.00x	1.10x

Rule	Detail
Multiplier scope	The 0.85 / 1.00 / 1.10 multiplier applies to a BOT's stat and money gains from ACTIONS only. Never to a human player, never to card effects, never to investment returns. Expose it in the debug panel so balance tests can run with it off.
Speed	Skip CPU Turns works identically at every difficulty. A Hard bot must not take noticeably longer in real time.
Fairness	Bots play by exactly the same rules: same prices, same gates, same rent, same cards, same turn limit. Difficulty is competence, not privilege.
Source of truth	The CPU_Difficulty sheet.

- Disconnect handling: if a joined player disconnects mid-game, a CPU bot takes over their character until they rejoin with the room code.
- Steam / open-internet matchmaking is explicitly out of scope for the MVP. Do not build accounts, lobbies beyond the room code, or netcode optimization yet.

21.3 CPU difficulty after the v7 playtest

Easy and Medium both played too well in the playtest. The v6 difficulty table stands, with these corrections.

EASY: picks at random from whatever it can afford in the building it is already standing in, and only travels when it has nothing to do. It forgets to eat on 40% of turns and to relax on 40% of stress checks, ignores the University entirely, never invests, never plans a purchase, and takes a job only when it happens to qualify. Easy should visibly flounder.

MEDIUM: plans the current turn only — no saving across turns, no education target beyond whatever is already affordable, and it travels for wages only when it is going that way anyway. It forgets to eat or relax on 15% of checks.

HARD is unchanged: it plans several turns ahead, targets education and job tiers deliberately, travels for the best wage and manages its investments by standing.

The bot-only gain multiplier (0.85 / 1.00 / 1.10) is unchanged and still applies to bot ACTION gains only, never to a human and never to card effects.

22. Art and asset notes

- Building art, character art, pet art, and the world map already exist and are held by the project's artist (not attached to this packet).
- Claude should build with simple placeholder art (colored blocks/cards with names) but load every visual through a single assets manifest (e.g. assets/manifest.json mapping ids to file paths like assets/buildings/regret_burger.png, assets/characters/enfp.png, assets/map/overmap.png).
- Audio files follow the exact filenames in Section 15 and live in assets/audio/.
- When the real art is dropped into the assets folder with the manifest filenames, it should appear in the game with zero code changes.

22.1 Stat icon audit (v7)

Several painted menus show the purple brain (Critical Thinking) on an action that actually grants the gold lotus (Enlightenment), and a few show the reverse. The engine is correct; the art is not. Every painted stat icon must be checked against the Actions_Master row for that action and repainted where they disagree. The Re-Education Temple is the worst offender, because almost everything there grants Enlightenment.

Art still outstanding: a painted card for Group Fitness Class at the gym; artwork for the SIDEWAYS MARKET and MARKET CRASH weekend cards; the Pet Shop bribe card still reads $50 where the game charges $10; the Mall HOME tab still shows v4 prices under live price tags; Low Cost Housing shows a TV and couch that are Luxury-only, so that room can never look fully furnished.

23. Build prompt (copy/paste into Claude or any capable model)

Attach this manual and the Balance Lock v6 spreadsheet, then paste everything below into Claude or whichever model you are using. Everything after this line is the prompt.

You are helping me build a game called Personality Panic. Attached are the Master Manual v6 (behaviour spec) and the Balance Lock v6 spreadsheet (all numeric data). The manual defines the systems; the spreadsheet is the single source of truth for numbers — load its sheets as data-driven arrays/objects, never hardcode scattered values.

IF I AM PATCHING AN EXISTING BUILD RATHER THAN STARTING FRESH: read the 'What changed from v1-v7' table at the front of the manual first. Every row names what changed, why, and the section that defines it. Apply the v7 rows on top of a v6 build; the V7 CHANGES block below lists them as build instructions.

READ THIS BEFORE IMPLEMENTING ANY NUMBER: the spreadsheet's Cost, Gain, Penalty and Pet columns are MULTIPLES of B, not percentages. A value of 1.0 means 100% of B. At the Short baseline (B=100): 0.05 = $5, 0.5 = $50, 1 = $100, 4 = $400, 20 = $2,000. Reading them as percentages makes low rent cost $1, luxury rent $4, the homeless cheque $2 and a car $20, and silently destroys the economy. The v6 headers say "(xB)" for this reason.

Important goal: make a playable MVP, not a huge final game. Do not add extra systems, buildings, stats, characters, events, minigames, skill trees, story mode, or Steam/online matchmaking. Playable beats ambitious.

BUILD TARGET

- Browser game: HTML/CSS/JavaScript client. For multiplayer, add a minimal Node.js WebSocket server so 1 player can host a room (room code) and up to 3 others can join from the same network; CPU bots fill empty slots. Keep all game state server/host-side; clients are views. If that is too heavy for the first pass, build hot-seat first but keep game state fully separated from the UI so host/join can be added next.
- Runs locally (npm start or opening index.html for hot-seat). No accounts, no internet matchmaking.
- Keep the code beginner-readable with comments; I am new to coding.

SCREENS (Manual Section 17)

- Start screen: Single Player, Multiplayer, Settings.
- Game Setup screen: humans (1-4), CPU bots (0-3, min 2 total participants), game length (Short/Medium/Long -> T=100/500/1000), TURNS PER GAME (10/15/20/30/50/Custom 5-100), CPU DIFFICULTY (Easy/Medium/Hard,

global plus per-bot override), turn timer (30/60/90/120/Unlimited), map (1 map, selector UI kept), hints toggle, skip-CPU-turns toggle, and 16-personality character selection with no duplicates.

- Settings screen: master/music/SFX volume, Music Mode (Full vs Overmap Only), mute, display mode, graphics quality, hints, skip CPU turns, timer warning sound.
- In-game screen: active-player panel (8 stats, pet stats, Money, Time Units, timer, job, hunger/stress/rent indicators), a persistent “Turn X of N” counter, all-player scoreboard, map with 14 buildings, per-building action menus, action results log, and a Skip button during CPU turns.
- End screen: podium ranking 1st-4th (or however many participants, min 2) with final scores and a per-player score breakdown, plus Rematch / Back to Setup / Back to Start.

CORE RULES (Manual Sections 2-15; numbers from the spreadsheet)

- Stats: main = Connection, Health, Career, Happiness; upkeep = Coolness Factor, Critical Thinking, Enlightenment, Money (Money = cash); pets = Pet Happiness, Pet Health. All stats cap at T.
- SCALING (critical): TWO scalars. T = stat cap / endgame threshold ONLY (Short 100, Medium 500, Long 1000). B = the base every percentage resolves against (Short 100, Medium 250, Long 350): stat gains, penalties, action costs, item prices, rent, job pay, card effects. Read every ‘%B’ in the spreadsheet as ‘% of B’. Because B grows slower than T, Medium takes ~2x and Long ~2.9x the turns of Short.
- Turns: 6 Time Units per turn plus the real-time timer. Costs per action type are in the manual/spreadsheet (Work=2, Travel=3, Eat=1, etc.).
- GAME LENGTH IN TURNS (CRITICAL — this was broken in the last build): the number of turns comes from the Game Setup screen and nowhere else. A “turn” is ONE ROUND in which every participant plays once; the counter increments when the round ends, not when a player finishes their go. The game ends when that round count is reached OR when a player maxes all 4 main stats, whichever happens first, and either way the current round is completed so everyone gets equal turns. There must be no hardcoded turn maximum anywhere in the code — the previous build ended at 15 turns regardless of the setting. Search for every literal 15. Also verify the counter is not incrementing per player turn, which ends a 4-player 60-turn game after 15 rounds and looks identical to a hardcoded limit.
- MENU RULE: never hide an action the player cannot currently take. Grey it out, leave it in place, and name the reason on the row (“Needs: Hot Tub - $850 at the Mall”, “Rent not due for 3 turns”, “Needs 4 more Low+ clicks”). A menu row that does nothing when clicked is a bug, not a design.
- PAY RENT (was broken in the last build): the Pay Rent action is listed in the player’s housing building on EVERY turn, costs 0 Time Units, and is never filtered out by the rent cycle. Four states: RENT DUE (amount shown, highlighted), PAID (shows next due turn), NOT YET DUE (shows turns remaining, pre-payment allowed), CANNOT AFFORD (greyed, shows the shortfall). On success deduct the money, play PP-Money.mp3, log it, and set the next due turn. Low rent $100, luxury rent $400 at Short.
- EATING: hunger for a turn is cleared by any action tagged Counts As = Eat in Actions_Master (including Order Fancy Food at the Luxury Apartments — this was missed last time), or by automatically consuming one unit of stored food supply at the start of the turn for 0 Time Units. Groceries are a supply purchase, not a meal.
- Upkeep: eat every turn or lose time next turn; relax every 2 turns or lose time; rent due every 4 turns; unpaid rent = homeless in the Park; Homeless Support Cheque at rent time enables recovery.
- Personalities: use the Personalities sheet — 16 types, each with 1 main/1 upkeep strength and 1 main/1 upkeep weakness. BALANCE PATCH v2: strengths +20% (Connection/Health/Happiness), +15% (Coolness/Critical Thinking/Enlightenment), +10% (Career/Money); ALL main weaknesses -10%, ALL upkeep weaknesses -8%. No perks — Career/Money-strength types intentionally land at a lower net stat budget (+2 to +7 vs +17 for other types) and are compensated purely by faster job/tier progression, not extra modifiers. Final Gain = Base x Personality x Pet x Best Item x Temporary modifiers, clamped to the per-stat max multiplier (1.45x/1.35x/1.25x); income multiplier caps at 1.25x.

- Buildings and actions: 14 buildings; implement every action row in the Actions_Master sheet with its Time Units, costs, gains, penalties, and requirements.
- Jobs: no promotions, no loyalty requirement. Players change jobs freely at Corporate Soul Exchange when eligible. A tier unlocks only when the player has BOTH the work clicks AND the education path: Low+ = 20 Low clicks + Path 1; Mid = 30 Low+ (or 40 Low) + Path 2; Mid+ = 40 Mid + Path 3; High = 50 Mid+ (or 60 Mid) + Path 4; Max = 80 High + Path 5. A work click = one Work action (2 Time Units), counted against the tier worked, accumulating across all buildings. Base pay per click (Short, scales with B): 40/65/110/170/260/400.
- JOB BOARD ORDER: render Jobs_Named sorted by TIER RANK 1-6 then by building, with group headers LOW / LOW+ / MID / MID+ / HIGH / MAX. Do not group by building. Keep locked tiers visible and greyed with the exact reason per row. Mark the player's current job.
- WAGES VARY BY BUILDING: pay per click = ROUND(tier pay x the building's Money Multiplier), from the Building_Map sheet — 1.00 at the Corporate Soul Exchange, Debtstreet and the Mall; 1.10 at Air One, the University and Regret Burger; 1.20 at the Gym, the Club and the Pet Shop; 1.35 at the Airport and the Temple; 0.85 for Work From Home. MONEY ONLY — never multiply Career, stat gains, card effects or investment returns. Travel costs must be real (2 Time Units to reach ring 3, 3 to reach ring 4) or the multiplier is a free buff.
- WORK ROWS PAY NOTHING: the Work rows in Actions_Master grant 0 Money and 0 Career. All of it comes from the job tier. In the last build both were granted, which double-counted Career and paid $6 a click instead of $40.
- CAREER (was far too easy to max — under 4 turns): Career comes from the job tier only. Tier values are 2/2/3/3/4/5. Course Career gains are halved (0.5/1/1.5/2/2.5 %B). Update Resume Secretly is 2%B and once per turn; Attend Team Building is 3%B and once per turn; Get/Change Job grants none. AND, most importantly, Career diminishes within a turn: the 1st Career-granting action this turn pays 100%, the 2nd 50%, the 3rd 25%, the 4th and later 10% — rounded down, minimum 1, counter resets each turn, applied in the order actions are taken. This applies to Career ONLY: never Money, never other stats, never card effects.
- HOME VS OUT (v7): home exercise gives a flat Health +1 per use, capped at 2 uses per turn, at both Exercise in Former Yard and Exercise in Condo Gym. The Bro Science Gym is the only real training in the game and pays flat Health +2 to +5 per action. Travel must buy something.
- LUXURY APARTMENT GATES: Sleep in Fancy Bed requires any bed owned; Take Luxury Bath requires the Hot Tub; Relax in Your Suite requires the Couch. v7: Host Friends has NO item requirement — the Fancy Dinnerware gate is removed; the item remains as an optional fixture paying Coolness +1 per hosting.
- Items: Mall purchases from the Items_Mall sheet. Prices are ABSOLUTE DOLLARS at the Short (B=100) baseline and scale with B. Enforce the Housing Requirement column ('Any' / 'Low Cost OK' / 'Luxury only'); Luxury-only items go to storage (not deleted) if the player drops to Low Cost Housing or becomes homeless. No mall item has a stat penalty. HOME FIXTURES are exempt from best-item-per-slot: every owned fixture fires its own flat trigger bonus (see the Bonus Trigger and Flat Bonus columns); only one bed counts. Fridge is required for 2-week and 4-week groceries.
- Pets: adoption at Ethical Pet Shop; pet bonuses per the Pets sheet. 3-strike feeding rule: miss 1 = Sad Pet (Pet Happiness -5%B), miss 2 consecutive = Starving Pet (Pet Health -8%B, Pet Happiness -8%B, final warning), miss 3 consecutive = pet dies: permanent tombstone rendered in the player's housing, owner Happiness set to 0. Feeding resets the counter. Re-adoption allowed; tombstone stays.

V7 CHANGES (Manual Sections 4.3, 5.4, 8.2, 14.4, 15.5, 16.5, 17.5, 20.6, 21.3)

TURNS: a turn ends automatically the moment a player's Time Units reach zero, including when travel spends the last of them. Never strand a player in a building with no legal action.

CLOCK: the Time Unit clock is always visible, is never covered by a dialog, and shows a clock face rather than an infinity symbol when the turn timer is Unlimited.

FREE PLAY: 1 human and 0 CPU bots is a legal setup. Minimum participants is 1.

NO 'MORE' DRAWER: every action a building offers appears in that building's own painted menu, using tabs when a scene has more actions than fit one page (for example a MALL ACTIVITIES tab holding window shopping and people watching).

JOB GATES: 20 / 30 (or 40 from Low) / 40 / 50 (or 60 from Mid) / 80 work clicks.

WAGES: pay per click = ROUND(tier pay x distance multiplier x efficiency multiplier). The efficiency multiplier is 0.85 at buildings where the player can also eat on site — Air One, Regret Burger and the Bad Decisions Club.

WORK COSTS NO STAT: remove every per-building Work penalty. Positive Extra Effects still apply.

INVESTMENTS: 0 Time Units to buy, sell or withdraw. Bonds, Stocks and Crypto are bought in $100 / $500 / $1,000 stakes; all returns are a percentage of the stake, not of B. Savings pays 3% of its balance per turn. Holdings and their value are shown on the main screen, not only in a dialog.

MALL: all purchases cost 0 Time Units. Rings $500, Bracelet $1,000, Earrings $1,500, Luxury Watch $2,000 (renamed), High Heels $400, Cap $30, Durag $20, Crocodile Sandals $25 with flat Happiness +5 and Coolness -5.

HOME VS GYM: home exercise is flat Health +1, max 2 per turn. Gym actions are flat points: Cardio +2, Chest Day +3 (Happiness +1, Enlightenment -1), Treninator Bootcamp +4 at $100, Personal Best Challenge +5 Health +5 Coolness +1 Happiness -1 Critical Thinking at $250, Suspicious Test Booster +5 Happiness +3 Coolness -5 Health at $50, Skip Leg Day +1 Health +2 Coolness -1 Critical Thinking.

CLUB: VIP Lounge $500; Get Digits and Flirt Recklessly are free.

FLIGHTS: Hawaii $500 (+3 Happiness); France $800 (+3 Happiness, +2 Coolness); Japan $1,000 (+4 Happiness, +2 Critical Thinking); Australia $1,500 (+5 Happiness, +3 Coolness); Long-Term Backpacking $5,000 and 10 Time Units (+5 Happiness, +5 Coolness, +5 Critical Thinking, +5 Enlightenment).

HOST FRIENDS has no item requirement.

WINNING BONUS — BIGGEST SPENDER: track money spent per player from turn 1 and award the top spender a bonus at final scoring (10% of T). Show it on the podium.

CPU: Easy picks at random from what it can afford where it stands, forgets to eat or relax 40% of the time, ignores education and investment entirely. Medium plans the current turn only. Hard is unchanged.

AUDIO (Manual Section 16; Audio_Music and Audio_SFX sheets)

- Play each building’s music track on entry; PP-Overmap.mp3 on the world map; swap to PP-OverMapRentisDue.mp3 on every rent-due turn (4, 8, 12, …) and revert after. Re-Education Temple has no track yet — fall back to the overmap music there.
- Music Mode setting: Full (default) or Overmap Only (building tracks disabled).
- SFX per the Audio_SFX sheet: walking loop, bicycle bell, car acceleration (movement sounds mutually exclusive by transport), menu click on every button, eating fast food, and PP-Money.mp3 on both earning and spending.
- Load audio from assets/audio/ using the exact filenames; if a file is missing, fail silently (no crash).

EDUCATION — HIGH IQ UNIVERSITY (Manual Section 13; Education_Paths sheet)

- 5 paths x 6 courses = 30 courses. Path 1 Technical Certification ($50/course, 1 click), Path 2 College Diploma ($100, 2 clicks), Path 3 College Degree ($150, 3), Path 4 Master’s ($200, 4), Path 5 PhD ($250, 5). A click = 1 Time Unit.
- Strict ordering: course N+1 unlocks only when course N is complete; path N+1 unlocks only when all six courses of path N are complete. Path 1 is available from game start.
- Completed courses grey out and are unselectable. Each course completes ONCE. A completed path can never be repeated or repurchased.
- Partial progress persists between turns; the in-progress course must finish before the next unlocks. The course fee is charged on the first click; if unaffordable, the course is unavailable.

- Completing path N unlocks job tier N (Low+/Mid/Mid+/High/Max) but is NOT sufficient on its own — the work-click gate must also be met.
- REMOVED: Take Class, Finish Undergrad, Finish Master's, Finish PhD, and Ask for Promotion. Do not implement them. Study Group, Flirt With Classmate, Cram All Night and Debate Professor remain as ordinary side actions.
- This also fixes the v4 bug where school courses were unavailable: courses must be selectable at High IQ University from turn 1.

INVESTMENTS (Manual Section 15; Investments sheet)

- Four assets bought at Debtstreet Capital: each bought with a stake of 1x, 5x or 10x B: Savings (+3% of the stake per turn, guaranteed), Bonds (+4%, guaranteed), Stocks (standing-weighted, mild), Crypto (standing-weighted, extreme; a rug pull destroys the stake).
- Buying costs the principal and grants NO immediate Money. Do NOT apply the Gain column on those purchase rows as an immediate gain — it is 0 in v4 by design.
- Max ONE holding per asset type; all four may be held at once. Each holding draws exactly one outcome card per turn.
- Cash Out Investment (1 Time Unit) sells one holding and returns 100% of principal.
- Only a crypto RUG PULL destroys a holding (principal lost). All other losses are Money deductions and the holding survives.
- Returns never compound: always a flat % of B.
- Read Tiny Print grants INFORMED: next Big Loss from any asset downgrades to a Small Loss, then consumed; does not stack.
- Take Lifestyle Loan: +15%B now, then -5%B auto-deducted at the start of each of the next 4 turns; one loan at a time.

WEEKEND UPDATE CARDS (Manual Section 12; Cards sheet in the spreadsheet)

- At the start of each player's turn, BEFORE the turn timer starts, show stacked cards the player clicks through: (1) status cards, (2) one investment outcome card per held asset, (3) exactly 1 event card. Apply effects immediately and write them to the action log.
- Status cards: S01 YOU FORGOT TO EAT! (-4 Time Units), S02 STRESSED OUT! (-2 Time Units; stacks with S01, minimum 1 Time Unit per turn), S03 SAD PET / S04 STARVING PET / S05 YOUR PET DIED per the 3-strike feeding rule.
- Standing: computed at the start of each turn from the live provisional score (ties: Money, then turn order). Event draw weights by standing are in the Cards sheet (last place is luck-weighted, 1st place karma-weighted, 2nd/3rd minor-only). 2-player games: leader uses 1st-place weights, the other last-place weights.
- Investments: resolve each held asset with the standing-weighted odds table in the Cards sheet. Bonds and Savings are safe: fixed small payout, never standing-weighted.
- Event cards: draw 1 from the Cards sheet respecting each card's Requirement (redraw if unmet). Effects cap at Premium (12%B). Card effects are NEVER modified by personality, pet, item, or temporary modifiers and ignore the 1.25x income cap — apply printed values exactly. Standing weights apply ONLY to card draws, never to base action gains.
- Weekend Cards setting is THREE-WAY: Full (default) / Essential (status + investment only) / Off (debug). Investments and status penalties ALWAYS resolve even when cards are Off — they are written silently to the log. Turning cards off must never change outcomes, only presentation. CPU bots auto-resolve their cards instantly.

ART

- Use placeholder art, but load every visual through assets/manifest.json (building images, character cards, pet art, world map) so the real art drops in later with zero code changes.

CPU BOTS

- Simple priority AI: eat if hungry -> relax if stress pending -> pay rent if due -> otherwise best affordable action for the bot's personality strengths. Support skipping/fast-forwarding bot turns.
- DIFFICULTY (Easy / Medium / Hard, set globally or per bot on the Game Setup screen, default Medium) per the CPU_Difficulty sheet. Difficulty changes bot BEHAVIOUR — action choice (random / top-3 / best), planning horizon, how often it forgets to eat and relax (40% / 15% / never), whether it pays rent reliably, whether it pursues education and job tiers, whether it travels for higher wages, whether it invests, and whether it neglects its pet — plus one clearly-labelled bot-only gain multiplier (0.85 / 1.00 / 1.10) applied to a bot's ACTION gains only. Never apply that multiplier to a human, to card effects, or to investment returns, and expose it in the debug panel so it can be switched off for balance testing. Bots otherwise play by identical rules: same prices, same gates, same rent, same cards, same turn limit.

DELIVERABLE

- Organized project (index.html, styles, game logic, data files, minimal server for host/join), playable start to finish, with a debug panel showing stat changes, money changes, turn history, and the winner's personality per game (for balance tracking).

24. Implementation priority order

24.0 If you are patching the existing build, do these first

These are the v6 fixes, ordered so that each one makes the next easier to test. Do not start on the rest of this list until they are done.

- **The unit bug (Section 3.1). Every cost and gain column is a multiple of B. Re-check rent, the homeless cheque, wages and every mall price against the dollar columns.**
- **The turn limit (Section 2.1).** One-line bug, and nothing else can be properly playtested until the game runs the length it was asked to run.
- **Pay Rent (Section 9.3)** and **Order Fancy Food counts as eating (Section 9.1).**
- **Work rows pay nothing; the job tier is the only source (Section 17.1).**
- **The Career patch (Section 14.3).** Play one game after this. Career should now be the slowest main stat to fill.
- **Job board re-order and the new Low+/Mid+ jobs (Section 14.1).**
- **Building wage multipliers (Section 17.2).**
- **Luxury item gates and the gym rebalance (Section 8), plus the greyed-action UI rule (Section 8.1).**
- **CPU difficulty (Section 21.2)** — last, because it changes nothing for a human player.

24.1 Full build order (for a fresh build)

- Start screen, Settings screen (with working audio settings), and Game Setup screen with character selection, turns per game, and CPU difficulty.
- Player state and stat display; load all spreadsheet data into game data objects.
- Map with 14 buildings and movement / transportation rules.
- Turn system with 6 Time Units and the real-time timer.
- Action menus per building with costs, requirements, stat changes, and log feedback.
- Hunger, stress, rent (every 4 turns), homelessness, and support cheque systems.
- Education system (30 courses, strict unlock order, one-time completion) and job progression (work-click counters per tier + education gates). No promotion action.
- Mall item buying with absolute dollar prices, housing gates, storage rule, and flat trigger bonuses for home fixtures.

- Pet adoption, care, the 3-strike feeding rule (Sad / Starving / Dead), tombstone rendering, and the death penalty.
- Investment system: four assets, principal purchase with no immediate money, one holding per type, per-turn outcome cards, cash out, rug-pull destruction, INFORMED status.
- Weekend Update card system: status cards, standing calculation, event deck with draw weights, investment resolution, tombstone rendering, and the setup toggle.
- Personality modifiers, pet modifiers, item modifiers, and multiplier caps.
- Audio: building music, overmap + rent-due swap, SFX, Music Mode setting.
- CPU bots with skip/fast-forward.
- Host/join multiplayer (room code, up to 4 players, disconnect -> bot takeover).
- End condition (turn limit OR all 4 main stats maxed, whichever first), final scoring, and the podium screen.
- Balance debug panel (stat gains, money changes, turn history, winner personality log).

25. MVP QA checklist

- Can the start screen reach Single Player, Multiplayer, and Settings, with click SFX?
- Can a host create a room and 3 others join with the room code? Do CPU bots fill empty slots?
- Does the setup screen enforce 2-4 total participants and unique personality picks?
- Do all 8 visible stats (plus pet stats) show correctly for each player?
- Does each turn start with 6 Time Units and end when they run out or the timer expires?
- Can players move to all 14 buildings, with the right music playing per building (and overmap fallback in the Temple)?
- Does PP-OverMapRentisDue.mp3 replace the overmap track on turns 4, 8, 12, … and revert afterwards?
- Does Music Mode = Overmap Only silence building tracks but keep overmap/rent-due music?
- Do movement SFX switch correctly between walking, bicycle, and car (mutually exclusive)?
- Does PP-Money.mp3 play on both earning and spending?
- Do building actions correctly check costs, requirements, and Time Units?
- Does eating prevent hunger penalties, and does skipping food cost time next turn?
- Does relaxing every 2 turns prevent stress penalties?
- Does rent trigger every 4 turns, homelessness trigger on non-payment, and the support cheque allow recovery?
- Do Career/Money-strength types correctly get their smaller +10% strength modifier with no extra compensation modifier applied?
- Can players get/change jobs freely at Corporate Soul Exchange, and does Work apply the correct TIER pay ($40/$65/$110/$170/$260/$400 at Short, scaling with B)?
- Do items count only the best item per slot for clothing, accessories, footwear, tech and transport — while HOME FIXTURES are exempt and all stack (best bed only)?
- Do personality strengths (+20/+15/+10) and unified weaknesses (-10/-8) modify gains correctly, with multiplier caps enforced?
- Can players adopt, feed, and care for pets? Do warnings appear before death, and does pet death set Happiness to 0?
- Does the game end after one player maxes all 4 main stats and the round completes?
- **v6: if the player sets 30 turns, does the podium appear after round 30 — not round 15?** Test 10, 20 and 50 as well.
- **v6: does the turn counter increment once per ROUND, not once per player turn?** Run the same turn count with 2 players and with 4 and confirm the game ends at the same round number.

- **v6: is ‘Turn X of N’ visible every turn, and is the last round announced as FINAL ROUND?**
- **v6: does the podium screen say which condition ended the game — the turn limit or a maxed player?**
- Does the podium screen rank all participants with correct score breakdowns (min 2 in single player)?
- Can CPU turns be skipped with the in-game button and auto-skipped via the setting?
- Does a disconnected player’s character switch to a bot, and can they rejoin?
- Do Weekend Update cards appear stacked at the start of each turn, before the turn timer starts, with effects applied and logged?
- Does the hunger card cost 4 Time Units and the stress card 2, stacking correctly and never reducing a turn below 1 Time Unit?
- Does the pet 3-strike rule fire the right cards (Sad at 1 miss, Starving at 2, Dead at 3), reset on feeding, render a permanent tombstone in housing, and set the owner’s Happiness to 0?
- Are standings computed from live provisional score, with last place drawing luck-weighted and 1st place karma-weighted event cards, and 2nd/3rd minor-only?
- Do Bonds and Savings pay the same fixed amount regardless of standing?
- Is exactly 1 event card drawn per turn, with requirements checked (redraw if unmet) and effects capped at Premium (12%B)?
- Does the three-way Weekend Cards setting behave correctly — Full, Essential (status + investment only), and Off (debug, where investments and status penalties still resolve silently into the log)?
- Does a Medium game actually take about twice as many turns as Short, and Long about 2.9x? (Measure turns-per-player to finish.)
- Do all percentages resolve against B and only the endgame threshold use T?
- Does buying an investment cost the principal and grant NO immediate Money?
- Is a player blocked from holding two of the same asset, and can they hold all four types at once?
- Does Cash Out return exactly 100% of principal and stop that asset’s cards?
- Does a crypto rug pull destroy the holding while a stocks crash does not?
- Does INFORMED downgrade the next Big Loss and then disappear?
- Do card effects ignore personality, pet, and item modifiers entirely?
- With Weekend Cards set to Off, do investments and status penalties still resolve into the log?
- Are Luxury-only items unbuyable in Low Cost Housing, and do they go to storage (not deleted) if the player moves down or becomes homeless?
- Can a homeless player with the $200 cheque afford low rent ($100), casual clothes ($50), AND food?
- Does Bribe Inspector cost money and grant Critical Thinking, and is Contact P.I.T.A. limited to once per game?
- Does the Lifestyle Loan deduct 5%B at the start of each of the next 4 turns?
- Are all 30 university courses selectable from turn 1 (path 1) and do they unlock strictly in order?
- Do completed courses grey out, and is it impossible to repeat a completed course or path?
- Does partial course progress persist between turns, and is the fee charged only on the first click?
- Is a job tier blocked when the player has the education but not the clicks, and vice versa?
- Do work clicks count against the tier worked and accumulate across all buildings?
- Is Ask for Promotion fully removed, and can a player switch jobs immediately with no loyalty requirement?
- Do mall prices match Section 16.3 exactly, and do they scale x2.5 / x3.5 in Medium and Long?
- Do all home fixture trigger bonuses fire together (relax with bookshelf + plants + mirror + dining table + stove + hot tub = +6 across five stats)?
- Does only the best bed count while all other fixtures stack?

- Are 2-week and 4-week groceries unavailable without a fridge?
- Do Durag and Crocodile Sandals apply no stat penalty?
- Can a low-tier worker afford rent, food, and still save toward the $300 Path 1 certification?
- Does the debug panel log the winner's personality for balance tracking?

25.1 v6 checklist (still required)

- Is low rent $100 and luxury rent $400 at the Short baseline — not $1 and $4? Is the Homeless Support Cheque $200 and the car $2,000?
- Does the Pay Rent action appear in the housing menu on EVERY turn, show the right one of its four states, and actually deduct money and update the next due turn when clicked?
- Does Order Fancy Food clear hunger and stop the YOU FORGOT TO EAT! card next turn?
- Does stored food supply auto-consume at the start of a turn and clear hunger for 0 Time Units?
- Is the job board sorted Low → Low+ → Mid → Mid+ → High → Max with group headers, and are locked rows visible, greyed, and labelled with the exact missing requirement?
- Does every building except Regret Burger now have a Low+ and a Mid+ job? Is Wolf of Debtstreet listed as Max, not Max+?
- Do the Work rows grant 0 Money and 0 Career, with everything coming from the job tier?
- Does a Mid-tier work click pay $110 at the Corporate Soul Exchange, $121 at Air One, $132 at the Gym and $149 at the Airport? Does Work From Home pay $94?
- Is the Money Multiplier applied to Money only — never to Career, stat gains, card effects or investment returns?
- Does reaching ring 3 cost 2 Time Units and ring 4 cost 3 Time Units from the hub?
- **Career check: with three Mid-tier work clicks in one turn, does the player gain 5 Career — not 18?** Does the 1st action pay full, the 2nd half, the 3rd a quarter?
- Does the Career diminishing-returns counter reset at the start of each of the player's turns, and does it leave Money completely untouched?
- Is Update Resume Secretly limited to once per turn at 2%B, and does Get/Change Job grant no Career at all?
- Starting from zero, does it take roughly 20 turns of career focus to max Career at Short — rather than under 4?
- Is Exercise in Condo Gym now 3%B and capped at 2 per turn, and Exercise in Former Yard 2.5%B and capped at 2?
- Do Cardio Session, Treninator Bootcamp, Personal Best Challenge and the new Group Fitness Class all grant Connection?
- Does Chest Day give flat Happiness +1 and Enlightenment -1, with no percentage Happiness penalty?
- Are Sleep in Fancy Bed, Take Luxury Bath, Relax in Your Suite and Host Friends all unavailable in an empty luxury apartment, each greyed with the missing item and its price named?
- Is Fancy Dinnerware buyable at the Mall for $250, Luxury only, and does it fire Coolness +1 on each Host Friends action?
- Is every unavailable action greyed and labelled rather than hidden, anywhere in the game?
- Does CPU Difficulty appear on the Game Setup screen, default to Medium, and allow a per-bot override?
- Does an Easy bot visibly forget to eat and skip rent, and does a Hard bot pursue education and travel to higher-paying buildings?
- Is the bot-only gain multiplier applied to bots only, visible in the debug panel, and switchable off?
- Do bots pay the same prices, face the same gates, and end at the same turn as human players?

V7 CHECKS

Does the turn end by itself the moment Time Units hit zero, including when travel spends the last of them?

Is the Time Unit clock visible and live while the course catalog, job board, Mall and card dialogs are open?

Does an Unlimited turn timer show a clock face instead of an infinity symbol?

Can a game be started with 1 human and 0 CPU bots, and does it play, score and show a podium normally?

Is there no 'More' button anywhere, and does every building's own menu list every action it offers?

Do the Mall's browse / window shop / hang out actions appear in a MALL ACTIVITIES tab inside the Mall menu?

Do the job gates read 20 / 30 (or 40) / 40 / 50 (or 60) / 80 work clicks?

Does a work click at Air One, Regret Burger or the Club pay 0.85x the distance-adjusted wage?

Does working anywhere cost zero stats?

Do investment purchases, sales and withdrawals cost 0 Time Units?

Can Bonds, Stocks and Crypto be bought at $100, $500 and $1,000, and do returns scale with the stake?

Does Savings pay 3% of its balance per turn, and is the balance visible on the main screen without opening a dialog?

Do Mall purchases cost 0 Time Units?

Are Rings $500, Bracelet $1,000, Earrings $1,500, Luxury Watch $2,000 and High Heels $400?

Do Crocodile Sandals give Happiness +5 and Coolness -5?

Is Host Friends available with no Fancy Dinnerware, and does owning the dinnerware still add Coolness +1?

Is home exercise capped at a flat Health +1 per use, and do gym actions give 2-5 flat Health?

Do Personal Best Challenge ($250), Treninator Bootcamp ($100) and Suspicious Test Booster ($50) match their v7 lines?

Is the VIP Lounge $500, and are Get Digits and Flirt Recklessly free?

Do the five flights charge $500 / $800 / $1,000 / $1,500 / $5,000 and grant their listed stats, with 10 Time Units on the backpacking trip?

Is money spent tracked per player, and does the podium name the Biggest Spender with the amount?

Does an Easy bot visibly flounder — wandering, missing meals, never studying, never investing?

Does every painted stat icon match the stat the engine actually grants for that action?

26. Current source-of-truth files

File	Purpose
Personality_Panic_MVP_Master_Manual_v7.docx	This manual: all rules, systems, screens, audio, multiplayer, and the build prompt. Replaces all earlier versions. the 'What changed' table is the standalone v6 patch list.
Personality_Panic_Balance_Lock_v7.xlsx	All numeric data: Settings, Personalities, Balance_Audit, Building_Map, CPU_Difficulty, Actions_Master, Items_Mall, Jobs_Named, Jobs_Tiers, Pets, Audio_Music, Audio_SFX, Cards, Investments, Education_Paths, Job_Progression. New in v6: Building_Map and CPU_Difficulty.
Asset folder (held by artist)	Building art, character cards, pet sheet, world map, UI mockups, and the audio files listed in Section 15.

Producer note: the visual direction and satire are already strong. The production risk is not lack of ideas; it is adding more before the loop works. Ship the first playable loop before adding new buildings, events, deeper lore, or extra character systems. # 27. Open questions for the next playtest

None of these block the v6 build. They are the things v6 deliberately did not decide.

#	Question	Why it is open
1	Heelton Heights — which building is it?	The playtest report names a building this manual does not. It is almost certainly the display name for the Luxury Apartments, but confirm it and record the mapping in the Building_Map sheet before the two documents drift further apart.
2	Option A or Option B on the work-click gates?	Section 14.2. v6 recommends Option B now that the game ends on a player-chosen turn count, but it is still formally undecided.
3	Are the building rings right?	Section 17.2 assigns rings from the intended map layout, not measured coordinates. If the built map places a building somewhere else, update the sheet to match the map — do not move the building to match the sheet.
4	Does Career now feel too slow?	Section 14.3 cut Career by roughly 4-6x in one patch. That is a deliberate overcorrection of a stat that maxed in under four turns. If it now feels impossible, raise the per-tier values and leave the diminishing-returns curve alone.
5	Do flat item bonuses still matter in Long games?	Carried over from v5 and still unresolved. Flat +1s are significant against a Short cap of 100 and nearly irrelevant against a Long cap of 1000.
6	Should the turn limit scale the job gates automatically?	If a player picks 10 turns, even Option B’s reduced gates are out of reach. A future version could derive the gates from the chosen turn count rather than from the game-length mode.